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Dear Students,

We are elated to present you the third edition of Kalam **Mains Marks Maximizer 2023. It contains quotes, anecdotes, references from the movies & books, poems, case studies** among others to enrich your mains answer writing.

Moreover, given the **elaborate coverage of data/facts/ committee recommendations etc.** in each other GS Marks Maximizers, we have not included them everywhere to prevent the repetition. We **recommend you to go through Separate Marks Maximizers** for the comprehensive coverage.

Further, knowing the content is one thing & application of the same to write a coherent, analytical & multidimensional answer is another. Thus, **we strongly recommend** you to watch the RLP videos (https://bit.ly/3rn934z) to know

- An alternative methodology to PESTEL approach to avoid writing mechanical essays
- How to go beyond merely one side of the case study (Ethics) in multiple dimensions & not make it boringly DESCRIPTIVE
- How not to miss out on the meaning & Hidden Dimensions of the mains answer writing
- How to leave your 'own signature'

We hope you are able to write better answer using this content & the strategy discussed in the videos.

Best Wishes!

(Team KALAM)

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- **Ethics Marks Improvement Booklet**
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01 Transformative power of Compassion and Forgiveness / Transformation of character

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Nelson Mandela**: Nelson Mandela, the former President of South Africa and anti-apartheid leader, demonstrated remarkable compassion and forgiveness. After spending 27 years in prison, he forgave his captors and worked towards reconciliation and unity in a divided nation, promoting forgiveness as a means to heal and move forward. 2) **Martin Luther King Jr.**: Martin Luther King Jr., the prominent civil rights leader, advocated for nonviolence and forgiveness in the pursuit of racial equality. He preached compassion towards one's oppressors and worked towards reconciliation and justice, leaving a lasting impact on the civil rights movement. 3) **Mother Teresa**, is widely celebrated for her extraordinary compassion and dedication to serving the most vulnerable members of society. She dedicated herself to caring for the dying, particularly those with terminal illnesses, in the slums of Kolkata (formerly Calcutta). She believed that every individual, regardless of their condition, deserved dignity, love, and compassion in their final moments. In 1950, Mother Teresa founded the Missionaries of Charity, a religious congregation that provides care and support for those living in poverty, the sick, and the marginalized. 4) **Role of IAS in demonstrating the compassionate behaviour:** a) **IAS officer Ramesh Gholap** has rescued at least 35 kids working in garages and hotels and sending them to schools when he was posted in Khunti and Bermo. b) **Compassionate Kozhikode and Operation Sulimani by Prashant Nair (IAS)** are other two initiatives which can be other two good examples reflecting a civil servant's compassion towards the weaker section of society. Kozhikode, in Kerala, launched a food programme called 'Operation Sulaimani'. Its aim is to avoid food wastage and to provide free food to the poverty-stricken section of the district. 5) **Angulimala** was dacoit who used to kill people and used to cut their fingers and made a garland out of those fingers. He used to live on a hill top. Once Buddha was passing by that hill. Angulimala got happy and came running to Buddha. He thought that Buddha would be afraid of him but instead Buddha was peaceful and quiet, smiling with grace and compassion. This was turning moment for Angulimala. He became disciple of Buddha and choose the good path after that. Later after 10 years, when same Angulimala returned to the village in which he had killed many people but this time as a saint, villagers started pelting stones on him, feeling the hatred they had for him. But he was quiet and peaceful just like Buddha, smiling with grace and compassion. Such gesture moved the villagers and then they also became disciples of Angulimala. Hence, we may face adversity in life but what matters is how we respond to it. We can **choose to be peaceful & forgiving** in any situation. We may respond like Buddha and the saint Angulimala.	1) "Compassion is not religious business, it is human business, it is not luxury, it is essential for our own peace and mental stability." - **Dalai Lama** 2) "Compassion is the ultimate expression of your highest self." - **Russell Simmons** 3) "Forgiveness is a virtue of the brave." - **Indira Gandhi** 4) "Forgiveness is not an occasional act; it is a permanent attitude." - **Martin Luther King Jr.** 5) "The weak can never forgive. Forgiveness is the attribute of the strong." - **Mahatma Gandhi**

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02 Never give up attitude/Perseverance/Determination/ Resilience

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) The experts of Spain concluded that **Columbus's plans to discover a new and shorter route to India** was virtually impossible. Queen Isabella and King Ferdinand ignored the report of the experts. "I can make it happen," Columbus persisted. And he did. Everyone knew the world was flat, but not Columbus. The Nina, the Pinta, the Santa Maria, along with Columbus and his small band of followers, sailed to "impossible" new lands and thriving resources. 2) **Thomas Edison:** A renowned American inventor, who is known for his unwavering perseverance and relentless pursuit of innovation. One of the most inspiring anecdotes that highlights his determination revolves around the invention of the incandescent light bulb. In the late 19th century, Edison set out to create a practical and commercially viable electric light source. The journey was filled with countless setbacks and failures, but Edison remained undeterred. He famously stated, "I have not failed. I've just found 10,000 ways that won't work." 3) **Viswanathan Anand** is an Indian chess grandmaster who has exhibited exceptional perseverance and dedication throughout his career. His **perseverance and dedication** allowed him to compete at the highest level for an extended period, demonstrating his **enduring passion** for the game. After losing his World Chess Championship title in 2013, he **continued to compete** at the highest level, eventually regaining the title of World Rapid Chess Champion in 2017. This ability to **bounce back from setbacks demonstrates his unwavering determination**. **(This anecdote can be used for Passion and Endurance.)** 4) There are thousands to tell you it cannot be done, There are thousands to prophesy failure; There are thousands to point out to you, one by one, The dangers that wait to assail you. But just buckle right in with a bit of a grin, Then take off your coat and go to it; Just start in to sing as you tackle the thing That cannot be done, and you'll do it. **Edgar A. Guest**	1) "It is our attitude at the beginning of a difficult task which, more than anything else, will affect its successful "There should be no boundaries to human endeavour. We are all different. However bad life may seem, there is always something you can do, and succeed at. While there's life, there is hope." **—Stephen Hawking, The Theory of Everything** 2) "The greatest glory in living lies not in never falling, but in rising every time we fall." - **Nelson Mandela** 3) "Perseverance is the hard work you do after you get tired of doing the hard work you already did." - **Newt Gingrich** 4) "Success is not final, failure is not fatal: It is the courage to continue that counts." - **Winston Churchill** 5) "Ambition is the path to success. Persistence is the vehicle you arrive in." **—Bill Bradley**

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03 Prejudice/Self Appraisal

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) A businessman was highly critical of his **competitors' storefront windows**. "Why, they are the dirtiest windows in town," he claimed. Fellow business people grew tired of the man's continual criticism and nit-picking comments about the windows. One day over coffee, the businessman carried the subject just too far. Before leaving, a fellow store owner suggested the man get his own windows washed. He followed the advice, and the next day at coffee, he exclaimed, "I can't believe it. As soon as I washed my windows, my competitor must have cleaned his too. You should see them shine." 2) **Homophobia and LGBTQ+ Prejudice**: Prejudice against individuals based on their sexual orientation or gender identity can result in discrimination, marginalization, and exclusion. It can lead to biases, stereotypes, and unequal treatment towards lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, and queer (LGBTQ+) individuals. 3) **Ageism:** Ageism involves prejudice or discrimination against individuals based on their age, particularly towards older adults. It can result in stereotypes, limited opportunities, and unequal treatment based solely on a person's age.	1) "It is harder to crack prejudice than an atom." - **Albert Einstein** 2) "Willingness to explore everything is a sign of strength. The weak ones have prejudices. Prejudices are a protection." **-- Anais Nin** 3) "What we perceive about ourselves is greatly a reflection of how we will end up living our lives." **– Stephen Richards**

04 Believe In Oneself

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
Before the idea for **Harry Potter famously came to J.K. Rowling** in a dream, the writer was a single mother struggling to pay her rent. Rowling battled depression and other obstacles. Even in those days, she had the belief that her novel would be successful. From no one to becoming one of the most successful female writers in recent history, as well as one of the most beloved British authors of all time, she has proved that believe system works.	1) "If you do not honestly believe in the good things that you tell yourself, no one else will care to listen either." — **Christine E. Szymanski** 2) "The more you believe in yourself, the more other people will believe in you." — **Wesam Fawzi** 3) "If you don't give up on something you truly believe in, you will find a way." — **Roy T. Bennett**

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05 Greed and envying others

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) Once there was a **dog who wandered the streets night and day in search of food**. One day, he found a big juicy bone and he immediately grabbed it between his mouths and took it home. On his way home, he crossed a river and saw another dog who also had a bone in its mouth. He wanted that bone for himself too. But as he opened his mouth, the bone he was biting fell into the river and sank. That night, he went home hungry. If we always envy what others have, we'll end up losing what we already have, just like the greedy dog. 2) **Harshad Mehta** was a prominent stockbroker and a symbol of India's booming financial market in the late 1980s and early 1990s. He gained immense fame and wealth through his unique strategies and manipulation of the stock market. The Harshad Mehta scam serves as a stark reminder of the consequences of unchecked greed. It demonstrated how the pursuit of wealth and power through unethical means can have far-reaching implications, affecting not only the individual but also the entire financial system and the lives of countless people. 3) **Coalgate scam**- The consequences of Mr. Gupta's greed were far-reaching. The scam deprived the nation of valuable resources and resulted in significant financial losses for the government. The cost of electricity soared, burdening the common citizens who were already struggling to make ends meet. The tale of the Coal Gate Scam serves as a reminder of how unchecked greed can corrupt even the most powerful individuals. It highlights the devastating impact such acts of greed can have on an entire nation, undermining trust in the system and hindering progress.	1) "Ignorance, hatred and greed are killing nature."— **Masanobu Fukuoka.** 2) "The world has enough for everyone's needs, but not everyone's greed"- **Mahatma Gandhi**

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06 Courage/ Responding in an adverse situation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Asha** was getting frustrated and tired of life, so she asked her father what to do. Her father told her to bring an egg, two tea leaves, and a potato. He then brought out three vessels, filled them with water, and placed them on the stove. Once the water was boiling, he told Asha to place the items into each pot and keep an eye on them. After 10 minutes, he asked Asha to peel the egg, peel the potato, and strain the leaves. Asha was left confused. Her father explained, "Each item was placed into the same circumstance, boiling water. See how each responded differently?" He continued, "The egg was soft, but is now hard. The potato was hard, but is now soft. And the tea leaves, they changed the water itself." The father then asked, "When adversity calls, we respond in the same manner as they have. Now, are you an egg, a potato, or tea leaves?" As a human being, we can choose to be an egg, a potato or a tea leaf during an adversity. 2) **Extraordinary courage in extraordinary circumstances - Neerja Bhanot** was just like any other 23-year-old, except when she came face to face with challenging times, she showed inexplicable and rare courage, something that helped save the lives of over 300 people. She died while saving passengers on Pan Am Flight 73 which had been hijacked by terrorists during a stopover in Karachi, Pakistan. Posthumously, she became the youngest recipient of India's highest peacetime gallantry, the Ashoka Chakra Award. 3) **Choices in adverse situation**: The **Blitzkrieg of Alexander's invasion** through Persia reached the doors of India in 326 BC. Back in the day, the region lying across Khyber Pass, Gandhara was ruled by two kings- Ambi and Porus. Frightened by the enemies' onslaught, Ambi surrendered even without a fight. Porus, however stood to his strength but was defeated. When asked by Alexander, how should he be treated, Porus quickly said- "Just as one king treats another." Impressed by his reply Alexander released his Kingdom and restored his status as a king. The above anecdotes evidently present to us a case of adversity but the way those two kings reacted also presents towards two choices to react to adversity- to be bitter or better. Ambi was bitter and thus is infamously remembered while the sagas of Porus sung even today. 4) **Anne Frank**, a young Jewish girl who documented her experiences while hiding from the Nazis during World War II, exemplified tremendous courage throughout her life. Despite the perilous circumstances, she fearlessly	1) "Success is not final, failure is not fatal: it is the courage to continue that counts." — **Winston S. Churchill** 2) "Bran thought about it.' Can a man still be brave if he's afraid?' 'That is the only time a man can be brave,' his father told him." — **George R.R. Martin, A Game of Thrones** 3) "You cannot swim for new horizons until you have courage to lose sight of the shore." — **William Faulkner** 4) "Courage is not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. The brave person is not one who does not feel afraid, but one who conquers that fear." - **Nelson Mandela** 5) "Courage is knowing what not to fear." - **Plato**

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expressed her thoughts, emotions, and aspirations, showcasing her determination to preserve her inner voice through Diary writing. Anne Frank maintained a strong sense of hope and belief in a better future, even when confronted with the atrocities and horrors of the Holocaust. Her diary, "The Diary of a Young Girl," serves as a testament to her bravery, resilience, and unwavering spirit in the face of unimaginable adversity. 5) **Malala Yousafzai**: Malala Yousafzai, a Pakistani activist for girls' education, survived a targeted assassination attempt by the Taliban in 2012. Despite facing threats to her life, she continued advocating for the rights of girls to receive an education and became a global symbol of courage and resilience.	

07 Attitude and Aptitude

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) Once, a young school boy was caught in a fire accident in his school and was assumed that he would not live. His mother was told that he was sure to die, for the terrible fire had devastated the lower half of his body. Even if he were to survive, he would be a cripple throughout his life. But the brave boy did not want to die nor did he want to be a cripple. His determination to walk was indomitable and his persistence finally paid off. He began to walk to school, then run to school, to run for the sheer joy of running. Later in college he made the track team. In February 1934, in New York City's famed **Madison Square Garden**, this young man who was not expected to survive, who would **surely never walk (poor physical aptitude)**, who could never hope to run – this determined young man, Dr. Glenn Cunningham, ran the world's fastest mile. 2) The story of **rabbit and tortoise** – The rabbit has the aptitude but the race is won by tortoise as it has the correct attitude.	1) "Ability is what you're capable of doing. Motivation determines what you do. Attitude determines how well you do it."- **Lou Holtz**. 2) "Weakness of attitude becomes weakness of character"- **Albert Einstein**. 3) "Aptitude without attitude is blind, Attitude without aptitude is lame"- **Richard Marcel**. 4) "The only disability in life is bad attitude"- **Scott Hamilton**

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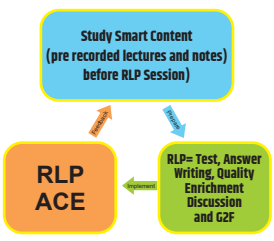
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08 Justice and Fairness

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Panch Parmeshwar by Munshi Premchand**: This story represents a situation many of us face-- when in a position of power, do we rule justly when a loved one is at stake or do we bend the rules? 'Panch Parmeshwar' is a story about two best friends Jumman Sheikh and Algu Chaudhary. A childhood friendship of the village panchayat is tested when, Algu has to make a decision that involved his friend's family. When Jumman's aunt approaches the panchayat complaining that Jumman took her property forcibly and is now ill-treating her, Algu - who is a representative in the panchayat- is in a dilemma because the verdict can change his equation with Jumman forever. However, Aglu took the right decision and gave judgement against the Jumman Sheikh. When it comes to justice, personal relation should not jeopardise it. This is what code of ethics also says. 2) **In Ramayana,** when Shri Ram shot Bali, Bali asked why he did that. Bali argued that he didn't harm Ram in any way. Lord Shri Ram replied that Bali had snatched away Sugriv's wife Ruma, who was daughter in relation to him. So, this was the most heinous act anyone can commit and therefore, Shri Ram says that this deserves death penalty. He said that it was his Dharma to get justice to Ruma and Sugriv. Good men can't remain mute spectator on evil man's act. 3) **When Gandhi Ji was thrown out of first-class compartment in South Africa**, he was not the first person to have met that treatment. The bad man, Britishers were busy torturing good man in the South Africa at that time. Gandhi Ji decided to act against this torture and started a movement against racial discrimination in South Africa. He got successful in many aspects. Later, it was Nelson Mandela who took active participation to eradicate apartheid. The movement finally culminated in black people getting rights on par with white people after the eradication of apartheid in South Africa. Good part is that the Black people did not throw out the white people from the country, rather they decided to stay together and make the Nation Great. 4) First, they came for the socialists, and I did not speak out—because I was not a socialist. Then they came for the trade unionists, and I did not speak out—because I was not a trade unionist. Then they came for the Jews, and I did not speak out—because I was not a Jew. Then they came for me—and there was no one left to speak for me. — **Martin Niemöller**	1) "The world suffers a lot. Not because of the violence of bad people. But because of the silence of the good people."- **Napoleon**. 2) "Justice delayed is justice denied." - **William E. Gladstone** 3) "Injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere." - **Martin Luther King Jr.** 4) "The arc of the moral universe is long, but it bends towards justice." - **Theodore Parker (popularized by Martin Luther King Jr.)** 5) "The true measure of any society can be found in how it treats its most vulnerable members." - **Mahatma Gandhi** 6) "Be the change you want to see in the world" - **Mahatma Gandhi**.

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09 Patriotism

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Uri: The Surgical Strike.** "Farz aur farzi mein ek maatra ka antar hota hai..Agar main apne desh..Apne bhaiyon ke liy ab nahi lda..Toh main apne hi nazron mein....Farzi bankar reh jaunga". 2) **Joan of Arc:** Joan of Arc was a French heroine who played a significant role in the Hundred Years' War. She led the French army to several victories, displaying immense patriotism and dedication to liberating her country from English rule.	1) "Sarfaroshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil me hai, dekhna hai zor kitna baazu-e-qaatil me hai" – **Ram Prasad Bismil** 2) "Even if I have to face death a thousand times for the sake my Motherland, I shall not be sorry. Oh Lord! Grant me a hundred births in India. But grant me this, too, that each time I may give up my life in the service of the Motherland."—**Ram Prasad Bismil**

10 Obsession with Change

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Steve Jobs' obsession with ideas**: In 1986, Steve Jobs brought the company, Pixar for $10 million. For many years Pixar could not do well. He was the only person who believed in Pixar. Within next few years, Steve Jobs pumped in $50 million from his personal pocket to keep Pixar going. Then after few years of toiling, then came the great success of Toy Story (In 1995) and the rest is history. This tells us that if someone has to change the world, he/she must be obsessed to do that. 2) **Steve Jobs' obsession for perfectionism:** Obsession with perfectionism pushed Steve Jobs to bring in refinement in all the works he has been associated with. From LISA to Mac to iPhone, he has proved that one should be obsessed to change the world. 3) **Elon Musk's obsession with pursuing risky business ideas:** In early years, Elon Musk believed the most likely outcome for SpaceX and Tesla was failure. But he proceeded anyway. He says that if you believe in something strong enough, it's worth pursuing – no matter the outcome. His obsession to explore new areas of science has changed the world. 4) **Vasco da Gama:** His obsession to pursue adventurous voyages led to the discovery of direct sea route to India. Whole world came to know this golden bird and things changed for India and the world. Communication links got established with India to Europe.	1) "No One Changes the World Who Isn't Obsessed."- **Billie Jean King** 2) "There is nothing permanent except change". – **Heraclitus** 3) "Aptitude plus obsession equals greatness" - **Josh Bezoni**

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11 Power and Character

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) There was once a **proud elephant who always bullied smaller animals**. He would go to the anthill near his home and spray water at the ants. The ants, with their size, could do nothing but cry. The elephant just laughed and threatened the ants that he would crush them to death. One day, the ants had enough and decided to teach the elephant a lesson. They went straight into the elephant's trunk and started biting him. The elephant could only howl in pain. He realized his mistake and apologized to the ants and all the animals he bullied. Be humble and treat everyone with kindness. If you think you're stronger than others, then use your strength to protect them instead of harming them.	1) "The measure of a man is what he does with power."- **Plato**
2) **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam:** Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, the renowned scientist and former President of India, was widely admired for his exceptional humility and visionary leadership. His life and work exemplify the harmonious blend of these two remarkable qualities. Despite his numerous achievements and global recognition, Dr. Kalam remained grounded and humble throughout his journey. He was known for his simplicity, approachability, and genuine concern for others. He never let success get to his head and always remained connected to the people he served. He often referred to himself as the "People's President," emphasizing his commitment to serving the nation and its citizens.	2) "Power tends to corrupt and absolute power corrupts absolutely"-**Sir John Dalberg-Acton**
3) **Lord Ram and Ravana:** In **Ramayana,** through his devotion and penance to the Great God Brahma, Ravana was made invincible and had the power to assume any form he wished, from men to mountains to death itself. He was so powerful that he could cause earthquakes and storms. But such a power made Ravana a monster who did innumerable adversities on mankind, even he unlawfully abducted the wife of lord Rama. His greed of power superseded his power of knowledge and rationality.	3) "Knowledge will give you power, but character respect" **-Bruce Lee**
4) **Adolf Hitler:** Adolf Hitler's rise to power and subsequent misuse of that power serve as a dark and cautionary tale in history. Hitler, the leader of Nazi Germany from 1934 to 1945, demonstrated the devastating consequences of unchecked authority and the dangerous manipulation of power. Hitler's misuse of power began with the exploitation of people's fears, frustrations, and economic hardships in post-World War I Germany. Once in power, Hitler centralized authority and dismantled democratic institutions, establishing a totalitarian regime that suppressed individual freedoms and marginalized dissenting voices. He used intimidation,	4) Nearly all men can stand adversity, but if you want to test a men's character, give him power- **Abraham Lincoln**
	5) With great power comes great responsibility- **Peter Parker principle, is a proverb popularized by the Spider-Man.**
	6) "So long as the millions live in hunger and ignorance, I hold every person a traitor who, having been educated at their expense, pays not the least heed to them!" **– Vivekananda.**

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censorship, and violence to control and manipulate public opinion, creating an atmosphere of fear and indoctrination.

One of the most horrific manifestations of Hitler's misuse of power was the implementation of his genocidal policies, particularly the Holocaust.

The legacy of Adolf Hitler serves as a stark reminder of the dangers inherent in the misuse of power. His actions demonstrate the potential for manipulation, oppression, and the erosion of human rights when power is concentrated in the hands of an individual driven by destructive ideologies.

Power and Authority:

5) **The Stanford Prison Experiment** was a psychological study conducted by Philip Zimbardo in 1971 to examine the effects of power and authority on human behaviour without proper oversight or accountability. While the experiment has been widely criticized for ethical concerns, it shed light on the influence of social roles and power dynamics.

The experiment demonstrated how individuals in positions of power, even when assigned temporarily, can exhibit abusive behaviour. Participants assigned the role of prison guards began to exercise their authority in aggressive and dehumanizing ways towards those in the role of prisoners. (**Role Conformity**) While the prisoners became submissive and compliant, highlighting the impact of social roles and expectations on behaviour.

Parental Authority: Parents have authority over their children, responsible for their care, upbringing, and guidance. They have the power to make decisions on behalf of their children and establish rules and boundaries within the family unit.

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12 Education, Knowledge, Skills and Wisdom

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam**, the renowned scientist and former President of India, firmly believed in the transformative power of education and its role in serving society. Throughout his life, he dedicated himself to promoting education and using it as a tool for social progress. Dr. Kalam recognized education as the key to **unlocking individual potential and empowering communities**. He believed that education had the power to eradicate poverty, bridge social gaps, and foster inclusive development. (Importance of providing quality education to all, especially to the underprivileged and marginalized sections of society.) As a scientist, Dr. Kalam understood the significance of **scientific and technological advancement** in driving socioeconomic growth. However, Dr Kalam's vision of education extended **beyond academic excellence**. He emphasized the importance of **holistic education** that nurtures not only intellectual growth but also **character development, ethics, and values**. He believed in **cultivating a sense of curiosity, creativity, and critical thinking** in students, enabling them to become lifelong learners and responsible global citizens. Dr. Kalam often **highlighted the concept of "knowledge with action" or "learning while serving."** He believed that education should not be limited to acquiring knowledge but should also inspire individuals to use their knowledge and skills to make a positive impact on society.	1) "Let us pick up our books and our pens. They are our most powerful weapons. One child, one teacher, one book and one pen can change the world." – **Malala Yousafzai.** 2) "Education must build character, enable learners to be ethical, rational, compassionate, and caring, while at the same time prepare them for gainful, fulfilling employment." – **NEP 2020** 3) "Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world." - **Nelson Mandela** 4) "Education is the key to unlocking the world, a passport to freedom." - **Oprah Winfrey** 5) "The fool wonders, the wise man asks." - **Benjamin Disraeli** 6) "Intelligence plus character-that is the goal of true education." **– Martin Luther King Jr.** 7) "Educating the mind without educating the heart is no education at all." **– Aristotle**
2) **Maharishi Valmiki**, is a revered figure in ancient Indian literature and is best known as the author of the epic poem Ramayana. Valmiki's journey **from a criminal to a sage-poet illustrates the power of education** to bring about personal growth, moral transformation, and social change. Through education, Valmiki acquired the knowledge, wisdom, and insight necessary to reassess his actions, find inner peace, and channel his creativity towards a noble purpose.	
3) **Malala Yousafzai**: Malala Yousafzai is a Pakistani activist who gained international recognition for her advocacy of girls' education. After surviving an assassination attempt by the Taliban for her activism, Malala became a global symbol of the fight for girls' education and co-founded the Malala Fund to support girls' education initiatives worldwide.	
4) **Kailash Satyarthi**: Kailash Satyarthi is an Indian child rights activist and Nobel Peace Prize laureate. He has been at the forefront of the movement against child labor and has worked tirelessly to rescue and rehabilitate child laborers	

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while advocating for their right to education. Kailash Satyarthi's commitment to the right to education serves as an inspiration for individuals and organizations working to create a world where every child can fulfil their potential and enjoy their fundamental rights. (**Transformative power of education**)

5) **Three Idiots Movie** - Two faces of the education system depicted
   a) The professor who says, 'Life is a race… if you don't run fast… you will be like a broken egg…' This represents the narrow view of life pursued relative to the person next to you, where education and success are all tools to get ahead in the rat race.
   b) On the other hand, the Protagonist says 'Learn to be capable, not to be successful' or 'don't run after success, chase excellence, success will follow you in a blink'. He takes a more holistic view of education, relating it to enriching life skills, experiences, capabilities, and possibilities. Here, education is more a personal experience and not an alienated commodity.

6) **Education and technology:** Rani, is a class 10 student studying in Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya in rural part of Jharkhand. She has great interest in mathematics and computing. Due to the collaboration of her school with information technology companies, she got a mentor who was a software engineer from the company. The mentor not only developed her in developing coding skills but also helped her in mathematics. The engineer also gifted her a tablet through which Rani studied online and did some projects too. Later in life, Rani became a scientist in ISRO.
   Kavita is a tribal girl from the same village as Rani. She studies in a local government school. Due to the pandemic, her school was closed and the education moved online. She had to walk 5 kilometres to go to the nearby village in search of mobile network to attend the classes. Due to her household responsibilities, this became difficult for her and she was forced to miss online classes.
   The above two stories of two girls from the same village highlights the opportunities and challenges that the edtech sector is presenting to us. At one hand, it is revolutionising the field of education in an unprecedented way while on the other hand. It is making education of privilege accessible to few.

7) **Rat race:** You will be amazed to see how rigorous is the routine of an IITJEE/NEET aspirant. The students usually would start their day early (At 6 or 6:30 am) and it goes on till 10 pm at night. Essentially, the child would be studying for 16 hrs a day, with a few breaks for food and personal maintenance.
   You could probably train Olympic athletes that way.

8) "Education that does not mould the character is absolutely worthless." – **Mahatma Gandhi**

9) Education without morals is like a ship without a compass merely wandering nowhere- **Martin Luther King Jr.**

10) Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man cleverer devil- **C.S Lewis**

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What the child misses? There is no time for personality development, sports, or anything else that might nourish the soul. It is just a grind until the mind goes numb.

And for the students who enjoy this and love science and maths, it is probably manageable – though I still feel it should not be this intense.

But many kids are not there because they wanted this grind – they carry the burden of their parents' dreams. At that young age, very few kids can assert and go against their parents' desires. And for the unwilling kids, this can be a severe trauma.

Our kids are not racehorses whose job is to win the race for us. They have their own life. Let us give them a chance to live. (**Story adapted from LinkedIn post of Mr. Rajan Singh**)

8) **Education without morality: The following examples illustrate that education alone does not guarantee ethical behaviour or morality**. While education can provide knowledge and skills, the cultivation of morality and ethical values requires a broader set of influences, including personal character, socialization, and a supportive moral framework.

a) **Ethical Lapses in Financial Institutions:** There have been cases where highly educated professionals working in the financial industry have engaged in unethical practices. The global financial crisis of 2007-2008 revealed numerous instances of fraudulent activities, including the misrepresentation of financial products, predatory lending, and insider trading.

b) **Unethical Scientific Experiments:** Throughout history, there have been instances of unethical scientific experiments conducted by highly educated individuals. One infamous example is the Tuskegee Syphilis Study, conducted by the U.S. Public Health Service from 1932 to 1972. In this study, African American men with syphilis were denied treatment so that the progression of the disease could be observed.

c) The **Nazi Regime's Education System**: During Adolf Hitler's rule in Nazi Germany, the education system was utilized as a tool for indoctrination. Children were subjected to a highly controlled and biased curriculum that promoted Nazi ideology, racial superiority, and anti-Semitism.

d) One always hopes to go or send one's children to the best of schools, colleges, and all. Why? How is a person from an elite school and grand university supposed to act? What do you imagine a person who attended from famous university, say Oxford, is like? Pictured something grand, didn't you? Well, one person popped this bubble, you will be shocked to learn that - **Osama bin Laden**, son of a billionaire is one of such persons. He definitely had high formal education, but his lack of moral values (strong gender bias, deep orthodoxy, etc.) gave birth to Al Qaeda. And further, brought the downfall of a progressive Afghanistan

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to its misery of genocide, chronic starvation, etc. of 21st century.	

13 Truth, Honesty and Integrity

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) Once an acquaintance came to meet great philosopher **Socrates**. He said "Socrates do you know what I just heard about your friend? Socrates stared back at him and asked before telling me anything I would like you to pass a little test-triple filter test. Socrates asked are you absolutely sure that what you are going to tell me is true. Men replied in negative. Socrates then asked is what you are about to tell me about my friend something good? Men replied in negative. Socrates then asked final filter is what you want to tell me about my friend going to be useful for me? Men replied in negative. Socrates then said Well, if what you want to tell me is neither true nor good nor useful than why tell it to me at all? 2) **Satyendra Dubey**, an Indian engineering service officer, was project director, national highways Koderma. He discovered serious financial irregularities in road construction and even got a few kms road rebuilt. It is said that he had written to PM about these financial irregularities. Eventually, he was found shot dead. Dubey's murder drew several protests in India and abroad, especially by the media. IIT Kanpur has instituted an annual award in his name, Satyendra K Dubey Memorial Award, to be given to an IIT alumnus for displaying highest professional integrity in upholding human values. His conviction to truth and courage is celebrated worldwide. 3) **Raja Harishchandra**- The tale of Raja Harishchandra stands as a timeless reminder of the power of honesty and integrity, transcending cultural and historical boundaries to inspire individuals to uphold truth in their lives. Raja Harishchandra was forced to work as a cremation ground guard to repay a debt. Despite his exalted status as a king, he embraced his new role with humility and continued to uphold truthfulness and honesty, even in the face of severe hardships. The story of Raja Harishchandra reflects the moral dilemmas and challenges faced by individuals committed to truth and righteousness. It emphasizes the importance of maintaining integrity, even in the most trying circumstances 4) **Mahatma Gandhi:** Mahatma Gandhi, the leader of India's independence movement, is widely revered for his principles of truth and nonviolence.	1) "Truth alone triumphs; not falsehood." (Satyamev Jayate)- **Mundaka Upanishad** 2) When the lamp of truth is lit, darkness vanishes by itself. - **Swami Vivekananda**. 3) In the end, truth alone triumphs. But, by then it's too late. – **Catalyst.** 4) There is no god higher than truth-**Mahatma Gandhi**. 5) Facts are many, but the truth is one- **Rabindranath Tagore**.

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His commitment to truth, known as "Satyagraha," was a central pillar of his philosophy and guided his actions throughout his life. "Satyagraha" which means "The force born out of truth".	

14 Practice makes a man perfect

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) There was once a pottery teacher called **Brian**. One month, he decided to split his class into two groups. Group A had to make a pot every day for 30 days (so 30 pots in total). Group B had to work on a single pot for the whole 30 days. At the end of the month, Brian judged the quality of the pots. Without exception, every one of the top 10 pots came from Group A, the guys that made one pot per day. None came from the group that focused on perfecting their single pot. Perfection can only be achieved by learning from the mistakes. Group A practiced for 30 times but group B only once and hence there was mediocrity in work of group B. **Practice makes a man perfect**. 2) **Cooking:** Chefs and cooks refine their culinary skills through practice. Experimenting with new recipes, mastering cooking techniques, and consistently preparing meals help them enhance their flavors, presentation, and overall culinary expertise. 3) **Michael Jordan**: Widely regarded as one of the greatest basketball players of all time, Jordan's commitment to practice and relentless work ethic played a crucial role in his success. Jordan would spend hours practicing his shooting technique, working on various shots from different angles and distances. He would focus on specific aspects of his game during practice sessions, constantly refining and expanding his skill set.	1) "Perfection is not attainable, but if we chase perfection, we can catch excellence." — **Vince Lombardi** 2) "Practice leads to perfection and perfection leads to succession." — **Amanda Jensen** 3) "The more you practice the better you'll be, the harder you train the great in you they'll see." — **Alcurtis Turner**

15 Freedom

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) At the **Google X lab**, employees are encouraged to 'shoot for the moon' and are rewarded for their failures. Google is able to constantly innovate because employees feel free to experiment even if they fail. It creates a safe space for employees. It encourages them to innovate best technology in the world and they are able to do this because they have the freedom.	1) "Freedom is not worth having if it does not include the freedom to make mistakes." **Mahatma Gandhi.** 2) "The unexamined life is not worth living"- **Socrates.**

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2) Where the mind is without fear and the head is held high Where knowledge is free Where the world has not been broken up into fragments By narrow domestic walls Where words come out from the depth of truth Where tireless striving stretches its arms towards perfection Where the clear stream of reason has not lost its way Into the dreary desert sand of dead habit Where the mind is led forward by thee Into ever-widening thought and action Into that heaven of freedom, my Father, let my country awake. - **Rabindranath Tagore**	3) "Life without liberty is like a body without spirit." - **Khalil Gibran** 4) "Freedom is the open window through which pours the sunlight of the human spirit and human dignity." - **Herbert Hoover** 5) "The only real prison is fear, and the only real freedom is freedom from fear." - **Aung San Suu Kyi**

16 Love and Life

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) You must have heard the famous dialogue of movie **Deewar.** Amitabh Bacchan says that "Mere paas Bangla Hai, Gadi hai, Bank Balance hai. Tumhare paas kya hai? (I have bungalow, car, and bank balance. What do you have?)". To this Sammi Kapoor replies, "**Mere paas MAA hai** (I have MOTHER)". A mother is the epitome of love, care, emotion and compassion. This incident clearly depicts that where there is love, there is life. 2) **Mother Teresa** had heard that there were many homeless men sleeping on the streets of London, and she asked to be taken to see them. Noticing one man in particular, Mother got out of the car and went to him. At first, he took no notice of her presence, but when she took his hand, he looked up and said, 'It has been a long time since I felt the warmth of a human hand.' Mother returned to the car and told us, 'This is a sick man. We cannot leave him on the street like this.' And she took the man to the Salvation Army. This highlights importance of love and how it gave meaning to her life. She later got Nobel Prize for her selfless service.	1) "Where there is love, there is life." – **Mahatma Gandhi**. 2) Love is life, hatred is death- **Swami Vivekanand.** 3) When the power of love overcomes the love of power, the world will know peace. - **William Gladstone**. 4) Life without love is no life at all- **Leonardo da Vinci**. 5) "Choose a job you love and you will never have to work for a day in your life."- **Confucius**. 6) **Gandhi** says, "logic be given to a logical person, rationality to a rational and love who believes in love". He considered soul as something pure.

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17 Consumerism and Materialism

While material possessions and consumerism can bring temporary satisfaction, true happiness and fulfillment often lie beyond the realm of material wealth. Finding a balance between our material desires and our overall well-being can lead to a more sustainable and meaningful approach to life.

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Black Friday and Sales Events**: Annual shopping events like Black Friday, Cyber Monday, and other sales promotions that encourage mass consumer spending, often leading to impulsive purchases driven by discounts and deals.	1) "The things you own end up owning you." - **Chuck Palahniuk**
2) **Social Media Influence:** The rise of social media platforms has contributed to a culture of consumerism, where individuals are constantly exposed to advertisements, influencers promoting products, and the pressure to showcase an idealized lifestyle through possessions.	2) "The greatest wealth is to live content with little." – **Plato**
3) **"Retail Therapy":** The act of using shopping as a means to alleviate stress or improve one's mood, where the act of buying and possessing new items provides temporary satisfaction or a sense of fulfillment.	3) "The consumer culture is the engine of social inequality." - **Naomi Klein**
4) **Obsession with Material Status Symbols**: Placing a high value on owning luxurious or status-enhancing items such as luxury cars, designer clothing, expensive jewellery, or high-end technology as a way to display wealth or elevate one's social standing.	4) "The more you have, the more you are occupied. The less you have, the more free you are." - **Mother Teresa** 5) "Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication." - **Leonardo da Vinci** 6) "Happiness is not in the mere possession of money; it lies in the joy of achievement, in the thrill of creative effort." - **Franklin D. Roosevelt**

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18 Science and Religion

Science and religion are two distinct domains that explore different aspects of human understanding and knowledge. While they can coexist and complement each other in certain ways, there have been instances where they have come into conflict.

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Aryabhatta's work on solar eclipses** not only demonstrated his scientific acumen but also exemplified his curiosity, rational thinking, and dedication to understanding the natural world. According to the legend, a royal astronomer challenged Aryabhatta to explain the occurrence of a solar eclipse. The astronomers of that time believed that eclipses were caused by the demons Rahu and Ketu swallowing the Sun. However, Aryabhatta had a different understanding. Aryabhatta proposed that solar eclipses are not the result of supernatural events but rather a natural phenomenon caused by the Moon blocking the light of the Sun. 2) **Medical Advances and Faith Healing:** Science has made significant advancements in the field of medicine and healthcare, leading to improved treatments and longer lifespans. However, some religious groups adhere to faith healing practices, where they believe that prayer and religious rituals can bring about healing. In certain cases, **conflicts may arise when individuals choose religious interventions over medical treatments** based on scientific evidence. It is **important to respect individual choices** and beliefs regarding healthcare decisions, but it is equally crucial to prioritize **informed decision-making** based on the best available scientific evidence. 3) **Science without religion is lame, religion without science is blind** is attributed to Albert Einstein and reflects his perspective on the relationship between science and religion. It suggests that incorporating both scientific exploration and religious or spiritual perspectives can lead to a more comprehensive understanding of the world and our place within it. "Science without religion is lame": This part suggests that science, with its focus on empirical evidence and the exploration of natural phenomena, may be limited in addressing existential questions, moral values, and the broader purpose and meaning of life. "Religion without science is blind": This portion emphasizes that religious beliefs and practices, if disconnected from scientific knowledge and inquiry, may lack a basis in empirical evidence and objective understanding.	1) "Science knows no country because knowledge belongs to humanity, and is the torch that illuminates theworld." - **Louis Pasteur** 2) "Science investigates; religion interprets. Science gives man knowledge, which is power; religion gives man wisdom, which is control." - **Martin Luther King Jr.** 3) "Science without religion is lame, religion without science is blind." - **Albert Einstein** 4) "The more I study science, the more I believe in God." - **Albert Einstein** 5) "Religion without science is superstition; science without religion is materialism." - **Swami Vivekananda**

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19 Self-Awakening and Self- Discovery

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Siddhartha Gautama (Buddha):** Siddhartha Gautama, the founder of Buddhism, experienced a transformative awakening known as enlightenment or "Bodhi." Through deep contemplation and meditation, he attained spiritual insight, realizing the nature of suffering and the path to liberation. This awakening led him to become the Buddha and to teach others about the path to enlightenment. 2) **Frida Kahlo:** Frida Kahlo, a Mexican artist, went through intense physical and emotional pain due to a bus accident that left her with lifelong injuries. During her recovery, she began painting, using her art as a means of self-expression and self-awakening. Through her vivid and introspective artwork, Kahlo explored her identity, emotions, and personal struggles, becoming a symbol of resilience and self-discovery.	1) "The greatest discovery of any generation is that a human can alter his life by altering his attitude." - **William James** 2) "Your task is not to seek for love, but merely to seek and find all the barriers within yourself that you have built against it." – **Rumi** 3) "The only way to do great work is to love what you do. If you haven't found it yet, keep looking. Don't settle." - **Steve Jobs** 4) "Your time is limited, don't waste it living someone else's life." - **Steve Jobs** 5) "Knowing yourself is the beginning of all wisdom." – **Aristotle** 6) "The greatest wealth is to live content with little." - **Plato**

20 Scientific Temper and Rationalism

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Raja Ram Mohan Roy's** advocacy for scientific temper and rational thinking laid the foundation for the social, educational, and intellectual reforms that followed in India. His progressive ideas continue to inspire individuals to embrace a scientific mindset, challenge superstitions, and promote critical thinking in their pursuit of knowledge and social transformation. Raja Ram Mohan Roy approached religious texts and traditions with a scientific outlook. He believed in interpreting religious scriptures in a rational manner and advocated for a more liberal and inclusive interpretation of religious teachings. He recognized the significance of education as a means to foster scientific temper. He championed social reforms aimed at eliminating irrational practices and promoting rational thinking. He fought against practices such as sati (widow	1) "The greatest enemy of knowledge is not ignorance; it is the illusion of knowledge." - **Stephen Hawking** 2) "Science is not only a disciple of reason but also one of romance and passion." - **Stephen Hawking** 3) "In science, there are no shortcuts to truth." **- Michio**

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burning) and advocated for the abolition of child marriage and female infanticide, based on rational arguments and humanitarian values. 2) **Alexander Fleming**, a Scottish biologist and pharmacologist, is widely recognized for his remarkable contribution to scientific enquiry with the discovery of the antibiotic substance Penicillin. In 1928, while working at St. Mary's Hospital in London, Fleming made a crucial observation that led to the discovery of penicillin. He noticed that a petri dish containing Staphylococcus bacteria had become contaminated with a mold, and the bacteria near the mold were not growing. Due to his curiosity, rather than dismissing it as an anomaly, he pursued the matter further and set out to understand the cause behind this inhibition of bacterial growth.	**Kaku** 4) "The scientific method is a means to an end, not an end in itself. It is the path to discovering the wonders of the universe and unravelling the mysteries of nature." - **Jane Goodall**

21 Leadership

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Ratan Tata**, the former chairman of Tata Sons and the Tata Group, is widely recognized for his exceptional **leadership and contribution to the business world**. He demonstrated **visionary leadership by transforming Tata Group** from a primarily Indian-focused conglomerate to a global business powerhouse. He expanded the group's presence internationally, acquiring companies like Jaguar Land Rover, Corus Steel, and Tetley, while also investing in emerging sectors such as information technology and telecommunications. He emphasized the importance of ethical conduct and corporate responsibility. His **commitment to social causes** was exemplified through initiatives like the **Tata Nano, a low-cost car** designed to improve accessibility for the masses. 2) **Lord Krishna**, a revered figure in Hindu mythology and philosophy, is often considered an exemplar of leadership. He **guided Arjuna, the warrior prince**, by imparting profound wisdom and reminding him of his duty as a warrior. This highlights the significance of leaders inspiring and guiding others towards a common goal. Lord Krishna embodied the qualities he preached, serving as a **role model for ethical conduct, righteousness, and devotion**. He showcased the importance of **leading by example** and earning the respect and trust of followers through one's actions and character. Lord Krishna's teachings reflected the concept of servant leadership, where leaders prioritize the well-being and growth of their followers (**Servant leadership**). His teachings and actions in the ancient epic, **the Bhagavad Gita,** offer insights into various aspects of leadership.	1) "The function of leadership is to produce more leaders, not more followers." - **Ralph Nader** 2) "Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality." - **Warren Bennis** 3) "The greatest leader is not necessarily the one who does the greatest things. He is the one that gets the people to do the greatest things." - **Ronald Reagan** 4) "The measure of a leader is not the number of people who serve them, but the number of people they serve." - **John C. Maxwell**

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22 Teamwork

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Teamwork in Space exploration**: One notable example of teamwork is the successful **Apollo 11 mission**, which achieved the historic milestone of landing humans on the moon in 1969. The three astronauts on the mission—Neil Armstrong, Buzz Aldrin, and Michael Collins—exemplified teamwork in their training, preparation, and execution of the mission. Each astronaut had specific roles and responsibilities that they trained extensively for, and they worked together closely to ensure the success and safety of the mission. The team at NASA's Mission Control in Houston, Texas, played a crucial role in coordinating and supporting the Apollo 11 mission. 2) **Fable of Bundle of Sticks**: The concept of the "teamwork and cooperation" is beautifully illustrated by the Fable of the Bundle of Sticks, also known as the story of the old man and his sons. The fable tells the story of an old man who had several sons who constantly quarreled among themselves. In an attempt to teach them the value of unity, the old man asked each son to bring him a single stick. Once all the sons had brought their individual sticks, the old man asked them to try and break each stick separately. Each son easily broke their stick without much effort. Then, the old man took the same bundle of sticks and handed it to his sons, instructing them to break the bundle together. Despite their combined efforts, they could not break the bundle. He emphasized that when the sticks were united together in a bundle, they became strong and unbreakable. But when they were separated, they became weak and vulnerable.	1) "Alone, we can do so little; together, we can do so much." - **Helen Keller** 2) "Coming together is a beginning. Keeping together is progress. Working together is success." - **Henry Ford** 3) "Great things in business are never done by one person. They're done by a team of people." - **Steve Jobs**

23 Food security and Hunger

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Greenview food bank:** Once upon a time, in a small town called Greenview, there were many families struggling to put food on their tables. Unemployment rates were high, and economic hardships had taken a toll on the community. It was during these challenging times that a group of compassionate individuals decided to take action and establish a food bank to help their neighbours in need. The idea began with a group of friends who realized that many families in their town were going hungry. They started by gathering surplus food from local grocery stores and restaurants, preventing it from going to waste. With	1) "We cannot build a sustainable world without ending hunger." - **Kofi Annan** 2) "The fight against hunger is ultimately a fight for freedom." - **John F. Kennedy** 3) "Food security exists when

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the help of generous volunteers, they set up a small makeshift food distribution centre in a donated space.

As the demand for assistance grew, the food bank expanded its operations. They reached out to local farmers, requesting donations of fresh produce and partnering with them to ensure a steady supply of healthy food. They also collaborated with other social service organizations to connect families with additional support systems.

The success of the Greenview food bank inspired neighbouring communities to establish similar initiatives, creating a network of support and solidarity against hunger.

2) **Community Gardens**: Community gardens are local initiatives where individuals and groups come together to cultivate and harvest food collectively. These gardens provide access to fresh produce, promote self-sufficiency, and foster community engagement and empowerment.

Imagine a residential neighbourhood called Greenview. The residents of Greenview noticed that there were limited access to fresh produce in their area, and they wanted to find a solution to address this food insecurity issue. They came together and decided to establish a community garden.

3) **International Cooperation and Aid:** International organizations and initiatives, such as the United Nations' World Food Programme (WFP) and the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), work to address global food security challenges. They provide humanitarian assistance, promote sustainable agriculture practices, and advocate for policies that prioritize food security at a global level.

all people, at all times, have physical, social, and economic access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food." - **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)**

4) "When the well is dry, we know the worth of water." - **Benjamin Franklin**

5) "No child should ever have to go to school hungry. It's a basic right that we must fight for." - Michelle Obama

24 Poverty And Unequal Oppurtunities

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Story of mother who refused to live in poverty:** Poken Bomjen, hailing from Arunachal Pradesh, got married at the age of 15 and, was widowed at a young age. From a state of hopelessness, she picked herself to be one of the most influential figures in the region today, by leading turmeric cultivation and capacity building through empowering SHGs. 2) **Education Disparities in India:** In India, unequal access to quality education is a significant issue. The case in point is the disparity between rural and urban areas. Rural communities often lack adequate infrastructure, qualified teachers, and resources compared to urban areas. This results in lower-quality education and limited opportunities	1) "Poverty is the worst form of violence."- **M K Gandhi**. 2) "Poverty is the parent of revolution and crime."- **Aristotle,** Greek philosopher. 3) "Extreme poverty anywhere is a threat to human security everywhere." - **Kofi Annan** 4) If you give a man a fish, you feed

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for students in rural areas to compete on an equal footing with their urban counterparts.

3) **The Akshaya project in Kerala** aimed to address the **digital divide among marginalized communities**. This initiative established Akshaya Centers in rural areas, providing internet connectivity, digital literacy training, and e-governance services.
The Gram Panchayat Internet Connectivity Project in Kerala aimed to bridge the **rural-urban digital divide**. Through this initiative, high-speed internet connectivity was provided to all gram panchayats (local administrative units) in the state.
The BharatNet project is a government initiative to provide broadband connectivity to all villages in India. It aims to bridge the **regional divide** by enhancing digital infrastructure and expanding internet access in underserved areas.

4) **Caste Discrimination in India:** India's caste system has historically created deep-rooted social and economic inequalities. The reality is how individuals from lower castes face discrimination and limited opportunities in education, employment, and social mobility. It can highlight the barriers and biases that perpetuate these inequalities and the efforts being made to address caste-based discrimination.

him for a day. If you teach a man to fish, you feed him for a lifetime.

5) Poor's basic mobility is from village to urban slums.

6) "Inequality is the social cancer that undermines economic growth, corrodes trust, and tears at the social fabric of societies." - **Christine Lagarde**

7) **Amartya Sen** on Poverty: People often die of hunger not because there is a shortage of food but because there is a shortage of "entitlements".

8) "We cannot build an inclusive society until we tackle the root causes of poverty and inequality." - **Ban Ki-moon**

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01 Women Empowerment

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Dangal Movie:** All along, I was desperate for a son so he could win a gold in wrestling for India. But what didn't occur to me was that gold is gold. Whether won by a boy or a girl." The movie reiterated the need to treat girls at par with boys, for they are both equally capable. The film takes on sexism and stereotyping existing in sports and stresses the issues girls face when they step out of their traditional roles. **"Hamari Chhori, Choron se kam hai kay?"** 2) **Sudha Murthy:** In 1974, the then India's largest auto manufacturer company TELCO published a job advertisement and it mentioned that only men can apply. It was easy to let this go, but one woman stood against this gender bias and written a postcard to JRD Tata complaining gender discrimination at TELCO. And it made the difference, JRD Tata changed the only 'male employees' policy and ordered to conduct interviews and examinations for female applicants also. And the women who wrote the postcard was granted a special interview and hired immediately. And thus, **Sudha Murthy** became the first female engineer hired at TELCO, opening the doors for many. **What made Sudha Murthy a strong woman? Her voice against gender discrimination**. 3) **Mary Kom: "Every medal I have won is a story of a difficult struggle." – Mary Kom** **Mary Kom** recollects her early childhood days as days of extreme struggle with poverty. Making a breakthrough in boxing wasn't easy as people saw it as a male sport. Moreover, her diminutive size made her path more difficult. And through all the struggle Mary Kom found her way to win the first World Championship medal in Antalya, Turkey in 2002. And the long list of glory follows. **What made Mary Kom a strong woman? Not give up and keep moving forward.** 4) **Women achievements in Science and Technology**: **Marie Curie** was a physicist and chemist who conducted pioneering research on radioactivity. She became the first woman to win a Nobel Prize and the only person to win Nobel Prizes in two different scientific fields (Physics in 1903 and Chemistry in 1911). **Katherine Johnson** was a mathematician whose calculations were crucial to the success of NASA's early space missions, including the Apollo moon	1) "I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved" — **Babasaheb Ambedkar** 2) There is no tool for development more effective than the empowerment of women. - **Kofi Annan**. 3) Educate a man and you educate an individual. Educate a woman and you educate a family. - **A. Cripps**. 4) "The day a woman can walk freely on the roads at night, that day we can say that India has achieved independence" – **Mahatma Gandhi** 5) Country can never be developed without the contribution of the other half. - **Mahatma Gandhi**

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landing. Her work helped ensure the safety and accuracy of space travel.

Valentina Tereshkova, a Soviet cosmonaut, became the first woman to travel to space on June 16, 1963, aboard the Vostok 6 spacecraft. She orbited the Earth 48 times during her mission.

Kalpana Chawla was an Indian-American astronaut and the first woman of Indian origin to travel to space. She flew on the Space Shuttle Columbia in 1997 and served as a mission specialist. Tragically, she lost her life in the Columbia disaster in 2003.

Data:

1) Article 15(3) - The state has the authority to provide particular accommodations for women and children.
2) Article 39(a) - Free Legal aid is providing assistance to the people who are unable to afford legal representation and access to the court system.
3) The representation of women MPs in Lok Sabha has slowly improved from 5% in the 1st Lok Sabha to 14 % in the 17th Lok Sabha.
4) According to NCRB, almost 300 crimes are committed against women per day.
5) According to NFHS-5 (2019-21): one out of every three Indian women experience violence.
6) A community radio program in Uttar Pradesh, for raising awareness about violence against women, "Bell Bajao!" (Ring the Bell) campaign, calls on men and boys to take a stand against domestic violence.
7) "Mpower 1on1" is a newly launched helpline in Mumbai to report domestic abuse.
8) McKinsey estimates that women do 75% of the world's total unpaid care work.
9) SDG-5: Includes on achieving gender equality and empowering women and girls: Ending gender identity-based discrimination, violence (in all its forms) and harmful practices.
10) The female labour force participation rate (FLFPR) in India has witnessed an increase to 32.8%, but still much behind the males (77.2%) -- Periodic Labour Force Survey released by the National Statistical Office (NSO) (June 2020 to July 2021).

02 Rural economy and Agriculture

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Gandhiji's Ideal village**- An ideal Indian village will be so constructed as to lend itself to perfect sanitation. It will have cottages with sufficient light and ventilation built of a material obtainable within a radius of five miles of it. The cottages will have courtyards enabling householders to plant vegetables for domestic use and to house their cattle. The village lanes and streets will be free of all avoidable dust. It will have wells according to its needs and accessible to all. It will have houses of worship for all, also a common meeting place, a village common for grazing its cattle, a co-operative dairy, primary and secondary schools in which industrial education will be the central fact, and it will have Panchayats for settling disputes. It will produce its own grains, vegetables and fruit, and its own Khadi.	1) "The soul of India lives in its villages." – **Mahatma Gandhi.** 2) "Almost half of the population of the world lives in rural regions and mostly in a state of poverty. Such inequalities in human development have been one of the primary reasons for

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2) **Farmer suicides**: Financial burdens caused by climate change and government policies have led to a rise in the number of suicides among agricultural workers. Maharashtra state has suffered more than most. The latest report of the **National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) in India**, said 5,563 agricultural laborers committed suicide last year and the number of people killing themselves in the industry increased by 9% from 2020, and **up 29% from 2019**. Most suicides were reported in Maharashtra, followed by Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. 3) **Amul success story**: The Amul cooperative played a pivotal role in transforming the lives of farmers and revolutionizing the dairy sector in the country. It stands as a shining example of the power of collective action and a sustainable approach to agriculture and rural livelihoods.	unrest and, in some parts of the world, even violence." - **A. P. J. Abdul Kalam** 3) "The strength of a nation lies in the prosperity of its villages and the well-being of its rural economy." - **Jawaharlal Nehru**

Data:

1) **Insights from the latest 'Situation Assessment of Agricultural Households and Land Holdings of Households in Rural India, 2019'**
   a) More than half of India's agricultural households were in debt, with an average outstanding of Rs 74,121 (Rise of 57% from 2013).
   b) Average income of agricultural households increased to Rs 10,218 in 2019 from Rs 6,426 in 2013.
   c) 69.6 % of the outstanding loans were taken from institutional sources while 20.5 % of loans were from professional moneylenders.
   d) OECD data: 85% of operational land holdings are less than 2 hectares and account for 45% of the total cropped area.
   e) Only 5% of farmers work on land holding larger than 4 hectares, according to the Agricultural Census, 2016.
2) Share of Agriculture sector has remained stagnant at around 17%-18%. In 2020-21, its share had increased to more than 20%.
3) The Gross Capital Formation as percent of agricultural GDP (16%) is much lower than the GCF of Indian Economy (around 30% of India's GDP).

03 Children

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) One day **Thomas Edison** came home and gave a paper to his mother. He told her, "My teacher gave this paper to me and told me to only give it to my mother." His mother's eyes were tearful as she read the letter loud to her child: "Your son is a genius. This school is too small for him and doesn't have enough good teachers for training him. Please teach him yourself." Many years later, after Edison's mother had died, he was looking through old family things. Now one of the greatest inventors of the century, he suddenly saw a folded piece of paper in the corner of a	1) "There is no greater violence than to deny the dreams of our children." - **Kailash Satyarthi** 2) "Children must be taught how to think, not what to think."- **Margaret Mead**

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desk drawer. He took it and opened it up. On the paper was written: Your son is addled [mentally ill]. We won't allow him to school any more. Edison cried for hours and then he wrote in his diary: "Thomas Alva Edison was an addled child that, by a hero mother, became the genius of the century."

2) **Every child is special – Key message from 'Taare Zamin Par'**- Taare Zameen Par is about a child who suffers because no one around him recognizes that he is a slow learner. He dislikes school and fails every test or exam. He finds all subjects difficult, and is belittled and berated by his teachers and classmates. But Ishaan's internal world is rich with wonders that he is unable to convey to others, magical lands filled with colour and animated animals. He is an artist whose talent is unrecognised. The film Taare Zameen Par also portrays the tormented life at school and at home of a child with dyslexia and his eventual success after his artistic talents are discovered by his art teacher at the boarding school.

3) "I may not have time for adults, but I have enough time for children" – **Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru**

4) "Everybody is a genius. But if you judge a fish by its ability to climb a tree, it will live its whole life believing that it is stupid" – **Albert Einstein**

5) "Don't worry that children never listen to you; worry that they are always watching you." - **Robert Fulghum**

Data:

1) **CONSTITUTIONAL PROVISIONS:**
   a) Article 21A: Right to Education
   b) Article 24: Prohibition of employment of children in factories, etc.
2) Globally, 1 in 10 children worldwide engaged in child labour.
3) In India, as per Census 2011, the number of child labourers is around 10 million.
4) 72% of all child labour occur within families.
5) **NFHS-5 FINDINGS:**
   a) Stunting: 38.4% of children under the age of five years i.e. One in every 3 children is stunted India has the second highest number of stunted children in South Asia (at 38%).
   b) Malnourishment: One in every 3 children is malnourished.
   c) Wasting: 17% of children under the age of five years.
   d) Underweight: 19.7% under the age of five years.
   e) Overweight: 4% of children under the age of five years.
   f) Exclusive breastfeeding among infants 0-5 months of age: 58%

2) FINDING OF OTHER REPORTS:
   a) According to a UNICEF report, India has world's highest number of children with severe acute malnutrition.
   b) In Global Hunger Index (2022), India ranks 107th out of the 116 countries. (India has performed worse than all the countries in the South Asian region barring war-torn Afghanistan.)

3) The 'Paalan 1000 campaign- Journey of the First 1000 Days', focuses on the cognitive developments of children in the first 2 years of its life.

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04 Social Justice

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **The Spectacle of 'Social Justice' Routed Through District Mineral Foundation Fund in Adivasi Areas.** Sixty-five Adivasi children from the Dantewada district have qualified for the NEET 2023 examination. They were given free integrated coaching in the district administration's institute called 'Chhulo Aasman'. This initiative provides free coaching to Adivasi children from classes IX to XII. The children are provided with residential facilities in the heart of Dantewada town along with quality study material. Most of the children are selected from residential schools located in the district. it becomes equally important to discuss the source of funding for this initiative. 'Chhulo Aasman' is funded by the District Mineral Foundation (DMF) Fund. 2) **Café Able**: Inside the Collectorate in Thoothukudi, people are usually seen waiting outside the Collector's office. Now they have a new space to hang out: Cafe Able. The cafe run by 12 differently-abled people has become a hometown hit in no time. The café aims to challenge social disabilities, showcase the abilities of individuals with disabilities, and promote inclusivity in the workforce. 3) **Vikram Seth:** Best known for his novel 'A Suitable Boy', Vikram Seth has been a renowned face in the literary circles for more than three decades and is regarded as one of the most influential writers of the modern era. Son of Prem Seth and Leila Seth, who was the first woman Chief Justice of a High Court in India, Seth studied at some of the best schools in the country before going to England for higher studies. His mother, Justice Leila has been openly supportive of him and has been a strong supporter of the gay rights movement. Her disapproval of Section 377 is known to the world.	1) "Social justice cannot be attained by violence. Violence kills what it intends to create." - **Pope John Paul II** 2) "Human rights are not only violated by terrorism, repression or assassination, but also by unfair economic structures that create huge inequalities." - **Pope Francis** 3) "The purification required is not of untouchables but of the so-called superior castes."- **Mahatma Gandhi** 4) "The soul has neither sex, nor caste nor imperfection."- **Swami Vivekananda**

Data:

1) **India has 104 million older people** (60+years), constituting 8.6% of total population. (Census 2011)
2) **Over 71% of elderly population resides in rural areas.**
3) **2.2%** of the total population are disabled (Census 2011). Among the disabled population 56% are males and 44% are females.
4) **Only 35%** of the total disabled persons are workers.
5) **Only around 55%** disabled are literates.
6) The total population- 4.8 lakh but only 30,000 are registered with election commission. (2011 census)
7) 99 percent of transgender people have experienced social rejections on multiple occasions.

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05 Sports and Youth

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Sandeep Singh**: He made his international debut in January 2004 in Sultan Azlan Shah Cup in Kuala Lumpur. At a time when he was at his peak, he was said to have the best speed in the world in drag flick (speed 145 km/h). On 22 August 2006, Singh was seriously injured after being hit by an accidental gunshot in Shatabdi train, while on his way to join the national team due to leave for the World Cup in Germany two days later. He was almost paralyzed and on a wheelchair for two years of his life. But Sandeep wasn't one to give up easily. The Punjabi in him didn't let him accept defeat and he scripted a glorious comeback, not only recovering from a serious injury but also establishing himself as one of the vital cogs in the Indian side. 2) **Stan Smith:** Once rejected to be a ball boy for being clumsy and uncoordinated, Stan Smith went on to become successful Tennis star. Stan went on to win Wimbledon, US Open and eight Davis Cups, and formed one of the most successful doubles team. 3) **Ravindra Jadeja:** He used to survive on a mere 10 Rupees a day. His father was a watchman in a shopping complex and he always wanted his son to join the army. His mother worked as a nurse and spent a considerable amount of her earnings on Jadeja's kit. But as destiny had it, Jadeja lost his biggest support, his mother at 17 and that so devastated him that he wanted to quit everything. Then he remembered his mother's last wish – to see her son don the national colour. Jadeja had an indifferent start and despite breaking into the Indian team, was a constant source of being taken a dig at. But nothing could stop him and he established himself as a top player.	1) "Always work hard, never give up, and fight until the end because it's never really over until the whistle blows." —**Alex Morgan** 2) "Don't be afraid of failure. This is the way to succeed." —**LeBron James** 3) "Winners never quit and quitters never win." — **Vince Lombardi** 4) "Life begins at the end of your comfort zone." — **Neale Donald Walsh** 5) "If you want to be happy, set a goal that commands your thoughts, liberates your energy, and inspires your hopes." —**Andrew Carnegie**

06 Social Media

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Poem on Media/Freedom of expression with responsibility/ hate speech/fake news** If an impulse comes to say Some un-thoughtful word today That may drive a friend away, Don't say it! If you've heard a word of blame Cast upon your neighbour's name	1) "I fear the day that technology will surpass our human interaction. The world will have a generation of idiots."-**Albert Einstein.** 2) "Social Media is about sociology and psychology

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That may injure his fair fame,
Don't tell it!
Thoughtful, kind, helpful speech,
'Tis a gift promised to each--
This the lesson we would teach:
Don't abuse it!

2) **Social media and democracy:** In March 2018. The New York Times and other leading media houses obtained a cache of documents from inside Cambridge Analytica. The documents proved that the firm used data improperly obtained from Facebook to build voter profiles. Cambridge Analytica sold psychological profiles of tens of millions of American voters to political campaigns.
The Russian connections with Cambridge Analytica further complicated the case, raising the questions on free and fair elections in USA.

3) **Dual face of social media:** During the initial days of 2020, Donald Trump put out a series of provocative tweets against the presidency of Joe Biden. He also indirectly asked his fans to storm Congress. Twitter exploded with his supporters sharing the message and they ended up storming the Congress, writing one of the dark events in American democracy.
A year later, in India, during the second wave of COVID-19, oxygen crisis had hit the country. People were flooding social media for help. And they did get help. Unknown people put up their best efforts to ensure that people get access to beds and oxygen cylinders. Social media turned out to be a saviour for many.
This is what social media is capable of. It can bring the oldest democracy to shame and at the same time it can bring the best side of the humanity.

more than technology." **– by Brain Solis**

3) "Distracted from distraction by distraction" **— T.S. Eliot.**

4) "One reason we use Instagram, WhatsApp, etc. indiscriminately is that they are 'free'. But are they?

5) Sometimes, the real price is not paid in money." – **Rajan Singh**

07 Economic Development

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Story of Vietnam's economic miracle** - When the 20-year Vietnam War ended in 1975, Viet Nam's economy was one of the poorest in the world, and growth under the government's subsequent five-year central plans was anaemic. By the mid-1980s, per capita GDP was stuck between $200 and $300. But then something changed. In 1986, the government introduced "Đổi Mới", a series of economic and political reforms, and steered the country to becoming a "socialist-oriented market economy". In essence, Doi Moi focused on the removal of self-imposed barriers to progress and the utilization of various market-oriented measures, including liberalization of the domestic market, encouragement of foreign direct	1) As **Pt. Nehru** said, "Long years ago we made a tryst with destiny, and now the time comes when we shall redeem our pledge. The achievement we celebrate today is but a step, an opening of opportunity, to the great triumph and achievements that await us."

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investment, or FDI, and the private sector, and reduction in subsidies to state-owned enterprises (SOEs). Today, Vietnam is one of the stars of the emerging markets universe. Its economic growth of 6-7% rivals China, and it exports are worth as much as the total value of its GDP. Anything from Nike sportswear to Samsung smartphones are manufactured in this ASEAN nation. 2) **The 1991 LPG (Liberalization, Privatization, and Globalization) reforms in India** marked a significant turning point in the country's economic history. These reforms, implemented under the leadership of then-Finance Minister Dr. Manmohan Singh, aimed to transform the Indian economy from a state-controlled and heavily regulated system to a more market-oriented and globally integrated one. These reforms ushered in an era of liberalization, privatization, and globalization, leading to sustained economic growth, increased foreign investment, and integration into the global economy. 3) **Lessons from the success of the Bangladesh textile industry:** None had ever thought that in 1971, when Bangladesh come into existence, that this small country will be the world's second-largest garment exporter (2.5 times that of India) and that too without a strong raw material base. Major lessons for India- a) **Leveraging economics of scale:** Bangladesh has a huge capacity which ensures to the global retailers and brands that this country will deliver their huge order on time and this bulk production also make Bangladesh cost-effective too. (MITRA scheme in India tries to leverage this.) b) **Diversification and specialisation:** In-house production of a variety of trims and even packaging material too. c) **Image/perception management:** Bangladesh has 135 LEED green garment factories certified by the US Green Building Council (USGBC). This country has 9 out of the world's top-10 green garment factories, on top of which 500 more factories are in the process of getting LEED certification. d) Timely upgradation to state-of-the-art machines.	2) The ultimate resource in economic development is people. It is people, not capital or raw materials that develop an economy- **Peter Drucker**

08 Democracy, Federalism and Decentralisation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) During the second half of 20th century, the discrimination against the **Blacks in the oldest democracy-USA** was quite prevalent. Rosa Parks became the face of the dissent when she sat on a	1) Bad officials are the ones elected by good citizens who do not vote. - **George Jean Nathan.** 2) "Every election is determined by the people who

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restricted seat on a bus. Civil rights movement finally led to the equal rights for Blacks in US. What would have happened, had Rosa Parks or the Blacks in general not dissented against the discrimination? It is hard to guess now but it is for sure that USA would not have been the flag bearer of democracy for long.

2) **Civil society:** April, 2011 has left lasting memories into the minds of the people of India. There was an old man named Anna Hazare threatening the Indian establishment with his Gandhian weapon of hunger strike to create an institution of Lokpal ombudsman. Huge crowd came in support of his demand as India was tired of scams and corruption. And the common aim was "India against corruption". What Anna Hazare represented was not just a crowd of aspiring Indians, rather it was the civil society which was determined to change the way things happen in India. The struggle of the movement ultimately led to the passing of Lokpal Act.

show up."- **Larry J. Sabato.**

3) "The ballot is stronger than the bullet"- **Lincoln.**

4) "Somewhere inside all of us is the power to change the world." – **Matilda.**

5) Democracy is "government of, by and for the people". -**Abraham Lincoln.**

6) A great democracy must be progressive or it will soon cease to be a great democracy - **Theodore Roosevelt.**

7) The lesson of history is clear: democracy always wins in the end. - **Marjorie Kelly.**

Data:

1) **Cooperation:**
   a) Passing of **Goods and Service tax Act**.
   b) **Niti Aayog** acts a think tank for whole country.
   c) **Zonal Councils** promote coordination.
   d) **All India services** help in maintaining a cordial relation and better communication with centre and states.
   e) **Seventh schedule of the constitution** make it clear which domain belongs to whom. It avoids unnecessary friction most of the time.
2) **Competition:**
   a) **Ease of Doing Business Index:** The Index for the Indian States with annual rankings pointing to the areas they excel and lags introduces the sense of competition among different states.
   b) **SDG India Index and Aspirational District programme: It puts a sense competition between states.**
3) **Confrontation:**
   a) Withdrawal of **Special status conferred on Jammu Kashmir (J&K)** Under Article 370 has created discomfort among some political party of the states. Hence, confrontation started.
   b) The passing of **Citizenship (Amendment) Act could not be communicated well in various states and there were protest and confront.**
   c) Passing of Farmers Act – Later had to withdraw.

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09 Climate Change and Environment vs. Development

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) The harsh land, scarce water, a limited labour force, and limited trade with neighbouring countries are the challenges in **Israeli agriculture**. However, the **kibbutzim** (collective community farming), 'can-do'-attitude are characteristic of Israeli agriculture. Israel is a world leader in agricultural research and development, which has led to dramatic increase in the quantity and quality of the country's crops. The drive to increase yields and crop quality has led to the development of new seed and plant varieties, as well as to innovations such as a soil conditioner substance (vermiculite) which, when mixed with local soils, boosts crop yields, and drip irrigation i.e., less water requirement. 2) Starting in 2015, **World Bank-supported project has been helping pastoralists adopted climate-smart agriculture in the SAHEL**—namely Burkina Faso, Chad, Mali, Mauritania, Niger and Senegal. The Interventions to improve animal health, promoting more sustainable rangeland management etc. are boosting productivity and resilience and thus helping to reduce carbon emissions. It is also helping in reducing poverty in the region. 3) The **Chipko movement in the small village of Reni in the Indian state of Uttarakhand** demonstrated the power of nonviolent resistance and community-led conservation efforts. The movement gained momentum in the 1970s when local communities, led by women activists, resorted to hugging trees and forming human chains around them to prevent their cutting. Its legacy serves as a reminder of the importance of local communities' role in environmental stewardship and the need for sustainable practices to protect our natural resources for future generations. 4) **Community led conservation efforts**: The community-led conservation efforts **highlight the importance of community participation, local knowledge, and sustainable practices in environmental protection**. The **tribal village of Mendha-Lekha in Maharashtra** is renowned for its community-led forest management. The village forest committee has developed sustainable practices for utilizing forest resources, ensuring the regeneration of forests, and protecting wildlife. Similarly, **Mawlynnong, a village in Meghalaya, is known as "Asia's cleanest village**." The community has taken collective action to maintain cleanliness, promote waste management, and preserve their natural surroundings.	1) "The third world war is at our gate, and it will be about water, if we don't do something about this crisis." - **Rajendra Singh, known as the "water man of India".** 2) "Thousands have lived without love, not one without water." -**W. H. Auden.** 3) "The water crisis is not (or not mainly) one of availability; it is, in the Indian context, at any rate, a crisis of gross mismanagement, and globally, a crisis of rapacity." - **Ramaswamy R. Iyer.** 4) "By polluting the oceans, not mitigating carbon emissions and destroying our biodiversity, we are killing our planet. Let us face it, there is no planet B."- **Emmanuel Macron, President of France.**

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10 Water Conservation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Village-led conservation efforts**: They highlight the importance of community participation, local knowledge, and sustainable practices in environmental protection**. In Rajasthan's Alwar district, the village of Kishori-Bhikampura established a community-led water management system known as "Pani Panchayat" or Water Parliament.** The villagers actively participate in managing water resources, resolving disputes, and implementing regulations for equitable water distribution. This initiative has led to the revival of traditional water harvesting structures, efficient water use, and sustainable management of water resources. Similarly, **Hiware Bazar, a village in Maharashtra's Ahmednagar district**, has transformed itself through comprehensive water and soil conservation measures. The villagers implemented watershed development projects, constructed check dams, and adopted efficient irrigation practices. Again, **Dhonavur village in Tamil Nadu** is known for its successful conservation of freshwater resources. The villagers have implemented rainwater harvesting techniques, constructed check dams, and practiced sustainable agriculture to conserve water. 2) **Cape Town's water shock and a warning before all:** Cape Town's water crisis got so bad in 2018 that there were competitions to see who could wash their shirts the least. Restaurants and businesses were encouraging people not to flush after going to the toilet. Cape Town faced becoming the first major city in the world to run out of drinkable water as the city was just 90 days away from turning off the taps. (Day Zero). It highlights the looming water crisis and calls for urgent water justice. 3) "Water, water, everywhere, And all the boards did shrink; Water, water, everywhere, Nor any drop to drink." — **Samuel Taylor Coleridge, The Rime of the Ancient Mariner** 4) **Low-cost irrigation model in Andhra Pradesh**: A unique sub-surface, plant root-zone-measured moisture system called System of Water for Agriculture Rejuvenation (SWAR) introduced. SWAR shifts irrigation from the surface to measure the moisture at the plant root zone. The root zone also serves as an ecosystem to foster microorganisms, besides rationing plant water requirements.	1) "We never know the worth of water till the well is dry." - **Thomas Fuller** 2) "Thousands have lived without love, not one without water." - **W.H. Auden** 3) "Water is the driving force of all nature." - **Leonardo da Vinci** 4) "Water is the soul of the Earth." - **W.H. Auden** 5) "Save water, and it will save you." – **Unknown** 6) "When the well's dry, we know the worth of water." - **Benjamin Franklin**

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Data:

1) India has **18% of the world's population**, but only **4% of its water resources.**
2) **Declining per capita water availability:** 2300 m3/person in 1991 to 1800 m3/person in 2011 to 1300 m3/person in 2021.
3) **Groundwater over-exploitation:** Groundwater levels in India → **declined by over 60 per cent** between 2007 and 2017 --> **90% of extracted water used in agriculture**.
4) **Recycling of water**: While **Israel recycles nearly 90%** of its water, India's recycling capacity stands at just 30%. The problem is worse at the household level, **where not even 5% of the water used is recycled**.
5) **Charkop Lake in Maharashtra, Ousteri Lake in Puducherry, Deepor beel in Guwahati** are well-known examples of water bodies that were encroached.
6) **Guwahati's Deepor beel**, for example, is used by the municipal corporation to dump solid waste.

11 Social Entrepreneurship

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Barefoot College and Bunker Roy:** Barefoot College, founded by social entrepreneur Bunker Roy, is an organization that focuses on empowering rural communities through education and skill development. It trains rural women to become solar engineers, providing them with the knowledge and skills to install and maintain solar panels in their communities, thus empowered thousands of women and improved access to clean energy in rural areas. 2) **Aravind Eye Care System and Dr. G. Venkataswamy:** It is a social enterprise that provides high-quality, affordable eye care services. It has become one of the largest and most successful eye care providers globally, demonstrating the potential of social entrepreneurship in addressing healthcare disparities. 3) **Grameen Bank and Muhammad Yunus**: The Grameen Bank, founded by Nobel laureate Muhammad Yunus, is a **pioneering example** of social entrepreneurship. It provides microcredit and financial services to the poor and marginalized, primarily women, in rural Bangladesh. By offering small loans without collateral, the Grameen Bank empowers individuals to start small businesses and improve their livelihoods. This approach has transformed the lives of millions, lifting them out of poverty and fostering sustainable development.	1) "Social entrepreneurs are dreamers who build a bridge to a brighter future." - **Melinda Gates** 2) "Social entrepreneurship is the ultimate expression of human potential." - **Paul Shoemaker** 3) "Social entrepreneurs are not content just to give a fish or teach how to fish. They will not rest until they have revolutionized the fishing industry." - **Bill Drayton** 4) "Social entrepreneurs are the bridge between what is and what could be." - **Skoll Foundation**

Data:

1) India has the **3rd largest** start-up ecosystem in the world.
2) There are **2-3 tech startups born every day**.
3) The number of **women entrepreneurs stood at 14%,** up from 10% and 11% in the previous two years.
4) **Corporate Connect: Facebook in partnership with Startup India disbursed cash grants of $50,000 each to the top 5 selected startups.**

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12 Health

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Local solutions to tackle anaemia:** Kavita is not keen on take-home ration (THR) because it does not taste good and it is often a hassle to remember to mix it with regular food. But Kavita is anaemic and needs extra nutrients to nourish her already weak body. There are many women like Kavita in several villages in the Pauri Garhwal region of Uttarakhand who need supplements for iron deficiency but do not take the necessary steps to take of their health. Ready to eat, tasty and iron-rich Jhangora laddoos come the rescue. Jhangora or barnyard millet, a rich source of iron and other nutrients, grows abundantly in Uttarakhand. A Swasth Bharath Prerak developed a laddoo recipe using jhangora and distributed it at Anganwadi centres instead of THR. She found that women loved these laddoos and came back for more. This idea worked well because it tackles diet diversity by using local resources optimally and also creates business opportunities for local women's self-help groups who are producing these laddoos at scale. It addresses the barrier of taste as well as convenience because it's ready to eat, unlike packed THR. It can be had as a snack, a post-meal dessert or even on the go but most importantly, it nourishes. 2) **Dana Majhi, a tribal man in Odisha** walked nearly 10 kilometers with his daughter, carrying his wife's body on his shoulder, after he was denied a mortuary van from a government hospital. The incident took place in the backward district of Kalahandi when 42- year-old Amang Deis died of tuberculosis at the district headquarters hospital. Majhi said that despite several attempts, he failed to get a vehicle from the hospital. "I told the hospital authorities that I am a poor man and cannot afford a vehicle. Despite repeated requests, they said they cannot offer any help." On the contrary, the urban India is building systems like apps and devices for getting instance medical care access. This stark reality between haves and have nots transverse across sectors in India. 3) A **one-and-a-half-year-old child in Jayanagar** in Bengaluru, stumbled and fell, smashing his face onto the edge of the bed which slit his lower lip. When his parents rushed the child (insured) to a reputed hospital, they were asked to admit the child. A slew of tests, including an MRI scan, were conducted. The three-day stay at the hospital, including the tests and suturing, came to a whopping Rs 78,000. Unheard of in the days when the general practitioner would simply stitch up the cut and send the kid back home, the parents felt. In another case, a child damaged her finger when it got jammed in a door. A private hospital said the surgical procedure would cost Rs 45,000-50,000. "When I consulted a trusted	1) "The best doctors give the least medicines." - **Benjamin Franklin** 2) "Prevention is better than cure." - **Desiderius Erasmus** 3) If you look at healthcare today, it's all about disease. It's not about understanding wellness at all – **Leroy Hood** 4) "The greatest medicine of all is to teach people how not to need it." **– Hippocrates** 5) "Health is a state of complete harmony of the body, mind, and spirit." - **B.K.S. Iyengar**

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doctor for my client's daughter, they said this surgery was not needed. When we admitted her in Indira Gandhi Institute of Child Health, the procedure cost just Rs 1,000.

4) **Telemedicine in India: A tool for transforming health care in the era of COVID-19 pandemic-** Health-care providers can incorporate telemedicine systems to **reduce doctor-patient visits** and help **in breaking the chain of transmission** of infections. During COVID-19 pandemic, telemedicine can also help in **reducing the burden on the tertiary hospitals** by providing diagnosis and treatment to patients in their own geographical location and reducing chances of patient's exposure due to hospital visits

5) The **Janani Express Ambulance Service, an initiative implemented by the Government of Bihar**, India, brought transformation by enhancing access to primary healthcare services, especially for pregnant women in rural areas. It helped improve access to timely and appropriate maternal healthcare for pregnant women in remote areas. The availability of ambulances ensured that women could reach healthcare facilities for antenatal care, safe deliveries, and emergency obstetric care, thereby reducing maternal mortality rates.

Data:

1) India is among the countries with the lowest public healthcare budget in the world.
2) As a percentage of GDP, Health expenditure stands at 2.1% of GDP in FY23 (it was 2.2% in FY22). (Target as per National Health Policy, 2017- 2.5 percent of GDP by 2025). {5% by China and Russia, 8% by South Africa, and over 9% by Brazil.}
3) Private healthcare caters to around 70% of India's population.
4) Out of pocket expenditures (OOPE): Due to several steps taken by the government on health, out-of-pocket expenditure as a percentage of total health expenditure declined from 64.2% in FY14 to 48.2% in FY19.
5) Health Infrastructure and Workforce:
   a) Around 65% hospital beds cater to 50% population of country: NITI Aayog
   b) India's doctor-population ratio is 1:834, assuming 80 per cent availability of registered allopathic doctors and 565,000 Ayurvedic, Unani, Siddha and homeopathic doctors- Better than 1:1000 as prescribed by WHO. (April 2022)

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13 Urbanisation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
Urban planning best practices: 1) **Chandigarh** is a well-known example of planned urban development in India. Designed by renowned architect Le Corbusier, it was envisioned as a modern, well-planned city after India's independence. Similarly, **Bhubaneswar**, the capital city of Odisha, has been recognized for its planned urban development and efficient infrastructure. The city implemented the Bhubaneswar Development Plan, which focused on balanced land use, integrated transportation systems, preservation of heritage areas, and provision of affordable housing. 2) The **Delhi Metro** is an iconic example of urban transportation planning in India. The DMRC developed a comprehensive and efficient metro rail network in Delhi, aiming to alleviate traffic congestion, reduce pollution, and improve connectivity. 3) **Contrasting reality of India's urban planning**: **Unplanned cities like Gurugram** growing beyond capacity adding to pollution and traffic hazards while the **planned city of Lasava in Maharashtra** failed to take off and remains devoid of urban life. 4) **Compact City Planning, Singapore**: Singapore has implemented a compact city planning approach that emphasizes efficient land use and connectivity. The city-state focuses on high-density development, well-integrated public transportation systems, and green building initiatives. **Waste management best practices:** 1) **Alappuzha** embarked on a project called **Clean Home Clean City** that focussed on source segregation as the first and foremost step towards effective waste management. This decreased the operational cost of dealing with waste as well as created a source of revenue. 2) **Surat's multipronged approach to solid waste management:** Surat doubled in size between 1981 and 1991, and faced a massive challenge to manage their solid waste to keep pace with the increased population. It adopted a multipronged approach of achieving 100 per cent source segregation, investment for construction, operation and maintenance, channelization of recyclables and refuse-derived fuels to achieve a high material processing efficiency.	1) "The city is not a concrete jungle; it is a human zoo." - **Desmond Morris** 2) "The future belongs to cities." - **Michael Bloomberg** 3) "Cities have the capability of providing something for everybody, only because, and only when, they are created by everybody." - **Jane Jacobs** 4) "The city is the theatre of life." - **Plato**

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14 Good Governance and Administration

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Armstrong Pame, the 'Miracle Man' of Manipur:** Armstrong Pame is the first IAS officer from the Naga people's Zeme Tribe. The 2009-batch officer is called the "Miracle Man" for building the 100km "People's Road" connecting Manipur to Nagaland and Assam in 2012 without government help. He raised Rs. 40 lakh through a Facebook page for building the road. He won several awards, including "India's Most Eminent IAS Officer Award" in 2015. 2) **Santosh Kumar Mishra - IPS officer educates poor children for free:** Santosh Kumar Mishra is a 2012-batch IPS officer hailing from Patna and posted in Uttar Pradesh's Ambedkar Nagar district. Apart from fulfilling his primary duty of maintaining law and order, he also educates underprivileged children to improve the state of education, realizing its importance for the country's future. During his time off duty, he teaches children and has also provided school bags to them. 3) **Sanjukta Parashar, the 'Iron Lady of Assam':** Sanjukta Parashar is a 2006-batch IPS officer of Assam cadre. She's known as the "Iron Lady of Assam". Parashar, a hardcore professional, killed 16 Bodo militants and arrested more than 64 of them while serving in Assam. She supervised the 2017 Bhopal-Ujjan train blast case. She's also the leading probe officer in the Sunjuwan terror cases and also investigated the Kashmir terror funding case. 4) **Gandhian Talisman for Governance** - Whenever you are in doubt, or when the self becomes too much with you, apply the following test. Recall the face of the poorest and the weakest man [woman] whom you may have seen, and ask yourself, if the step you contemplate is going to be of any use to him [her]. Will he [she] gain anything by it? Will it restore him [her] to a control over his [her] own life and destiny? In other words, will it lead to swaraj [freedom] for the hungry and spiritually starving millions?	1) "Good governance is the foundation to achieve sustainable development" – **United Nations** 2) "Good governance is the art of putting wise thought into prudent action in a way that advances the well-being of those governed" – **Diane Kalen Sukra** 3) "The worst disease in the world is corruption. And there is cure also, Transparency."

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15 Globalisation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) Four decades back, the burning issue in front of the world was the widening of the **Ozone hole over the Antarctica**. Scientists claimed it to have long term consequences on the human life. However, the world proved it wrong through a successful implementation Of Montreal protocol – the most successful evidence of International Corporation. And thus, recent studies indicate the ozone hole to fully heal sometime between 2040 and 2070. 2) **Globalisation:** a) **Positive Impact:** Susmita was newly married during 1980s. She is an artist who could do handicraft on cloths. Though she was very talented and skilful and could make more than 30 handicrafts in a year but due to lack of demand, she could hardly sell 3-4 of her handicraft's shawls in a year. She was not even getting the optimum price for that. Many a times she had to settle for a loss. But these situations changed after globalisation. After globalisation, she got the market access. Now she could even export the shawl. Now, Susmita is owning a small factory, where more than 50 skilful females are working. Recently, Susmita has exported her shawls in European countries like France, Germany and England. Her small venture is making lots of profit every year. She has fulfilled all her dreams through this. This is the advantage of globalisation has in our society and country. It has empowered people even at grassroot level. b) **Negative Impact:** Shyam Prasad is living in a small village in Uttar Pradesh. When he was a child, his family was joint. His grandmother, grandfather, uncles, aunties, cousins all used to live in same house. There were lots of respect and love for each other. Everyone listened to what his grandfather used to say. But after globalisation, the only son of Shyam Prasad has shifted to USA as he is working in a software company there. Now, the Shyam Prasad is living alone with her wife in his house. There is no one to take care of her. Family has been separated. His brothers have separate families now. This changing family system from the joint family to nuclear family is due to globalisation. It has put old aged person in our society in distress situation. Globalization is a double-edged sword.	1) "The world is becoming more connected and globalized. We must learn to live together as brothers or perish together as fools." - **Martin Luther King Jr**. 2) "Globalization is not just about markets and money. It is about people and their aspirations." - **Ban Ki-moon** 3) "Globalization is an irreversible reality. But we need to make globalization work for the many, not just the few." - **Ban Ki-moon** 4) "Globalization is not about homogenization, but about celebrating diversity and embracing the richness of different cultures and perspectives." - Unknown

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16 Technology, Artificial Intelligence

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **AI in Fraud Detection, United States**: The U.S. federal government has utilized AI to enhance fraud detection and prevention. The Internal Revenue Service (IRS) implemented AI algorithms to identify potential tax fraud cases more efficiently. 2) **Microsoft's AI Network for Healthcare and Apollo Hospitals** are developing a machine learning model to predict the potential risk of heart attacks using clinical and lab data from over 400,000 patients. The AI solution can identify new risk factors and provide a heart risk score to patients without the need for a detailed health check-up. 3) **AI in Traffic Management, China**: China has leveraged AI technologies for traffic management in several cities. For instance, in Hangzhou, the city's traffic police implemented AI-powered systems to monitor traffic violations, detect rule-breaking behaviours, and issue automated fines. The AI algorithms analyze real-time traffic data, surveillance footage, and vehicle information to identify violations and promote safer driving practices, leading to improved traffic management and reduced congestion. 4) **Use of Drone:** When a glacial breach took place in the Chamoli district in Uttarakhand in February 2021, the AGNIi team used drone technology for the rescue operations. The drones were used for searching such places for human causalities where normal person could not reach. Drones were also used to distribute food packets in the flooded zone. Along with this, the drones provided surveillance footage of the adjoining areas. This shows how technology can be used for disaster management.	1) "Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master." - **Christian Lous Lange** 2) "It has become appallingly obvious that our technology has exceeded our humanity." - **Albert Einstein** 3) "The development of full artificial intelligence could spell the end of the human race." – **Stephen Hawking** 4) "Artificial intelligence is not a substitute for human intelligence. It's a tool that can be used to augment human capabilities." - **Thomas H. Davenport** 5) "Artificial intelligence, deep learning, machine learning—whatever you're doing if you don't understand it—the dark secret is you're working in a field you don't understand." - **Elon Musk**

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17 Financial Inclusion

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY):** The PMJDY is a national financial inclusion program launched by the Government of India. It aims to provide universal access to banking services, including savings accounts, remittance, credit, insurance, and pension facilities, to all households in India. The program focuses on reaching the unbanked population, particularly those in rural and remote areas. 2) **Direct Benefits Transfer:** A key policy driver in women's uptake and use of financial services in India has been the Direct Benefits Transfer (DBT) initiative for women account holders. Through the DBT system, the government directly transfers cash into the bank account of beneficiaries. DBT covers 319 schemes, the biggest ones including wages for the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, LPG subsidy, and free food grains under the Public Distribution System. a 2019 study in Madhya Pradesh found that greater control over earned income can increase women's household bargaining power.	1) "Financial inclusion is the key to unlocking the potential of individuals and communities." - **António Guterres** 2) "Financial inclusion is the pathway to reducing poverty and fostering economic growth." - **Christine Lagarde** 3) "Financial inclusion is about giving everyone, regardless of their socioeconomic background, the opportunity to build a better future." - **Arundhati Bhattacharya** 4) "Financial inclusion is the key to unlocking entrepreneurial potential and driving economic growth." - **Ivanka Trump**

Data:

1) Financial inclusion has been identified as an enabler for 7 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals.
2) Jan Dhan – Aadhaar – Mobile (JAM Trinity):
   a) Over 430 million bank accounts with a cumulative of Rs 1.46 trillion under Jan Dhan accounts.
   b) 55% of Jan Dhan account holders are women and 67% of the overall account holders reside in rural and semi-urban areas.
   c) According to PMJDY's progress report, almost 100% of household coverage has been recorded in all the states/UTs.
   d) Jan Dhan Darshak App: launched to provide a citizen-centric platform for locating banking touchpoints.
3) RBI's annual Financial Inclusion Index in 2021 stood at 53.9 as against 43.4 for the period ending March 2017, showing drastic improvement in the past four years.
4) Global case study: Mobile money service in Kenya, M-PESA, found mobile money has lifted as many as 194,000 households – 2% of the Kenyan population – out of poverty, and has been effective in improving the economic lives of poor women and of members of female-headed households.

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18 Energy Security and Renewable Energy

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Solar Electrification in Chhattisgarh Villages**: The initiative involves the installation of solar photovoltaic (PV) systems to provide electricity for households, schools, and community centers. By bringing clean energy to off-grid areas, this project has improved the quality of life for residents and reduced dependence on traditional fossil fuel-based energy sources. 2) **Cochin International Airport Solar Power Project:** It is located in Kerala, and became the first fully solar-powered airport in the world. The solar panels generate more electricity than the airport requires, allowing the surplus power to be fed back into the grid. The project showcases the potential of renewable energy in the transportation sector and demonstrates the airport's commitment to sustainability. 3) **Community-Led Renewable Energy Projects in Germany:** Through its Energiewende (Energy Transition) policy, the country has encouraged local communities to participate in renewable energy generation. Citizens, cooperatives, and municipalities have developed wind farms, solar installations, and biogas facilities, allowing them to become active participants in the clean energy transition. These community-led projects have not only reduced carbon emissions but also provided economic benefits and strengthened social cohesion.	1) "The sun, the wind, and the waves are all renewable sources of energy. They are gifts of nature, and we should use them to power our future." - **Rajendra Pachauri** 2) "Renewable energy is the key to a sustainable and secure energy future." - **Ban Ki-moon** 3) "Renewable energy is not a choice; it is a necessity if we want to protect our planet and ensure a sustainable future." - **François Hollande** 4) "The power of renewable energy lies not only in its ability to generate electricity but also in its potential to transform lives and communities." - **Alok Sharma**

Data:

1) **India ranked third globally for total renewable power capacity additions with 15.4 GW in 2021, following China (136 GW) and the US (43 GW).**
2) Installed capacity for Renewables (Feb 2023):
   Wind power: 42.6 GW
   Solar Power: 66.7 GW
   Biomass: 10.2 GW
   Small Hydro Power: 4.94 GW
3) **INDIA HAS ACHIEVED CLEAN ENERGY TARGETS NINE YEARS AHEAD OF SCHEDULE**- India's share of renewable energy capacity comes to 162 GW, which is 41% of the 402 GW of electricity installed.

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19 Space Exploration and Technology

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **The Mars Orbiter Mission**, launched by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on November 5, 2013, aimed to study Mars' atmosphere, surface features, and its potential for supporting life. The primary objective was to demonstrate India's technological capabilities in interplanetary space exploration. It successfully entered the orbit of Mars, making India the first Asian country to achieve this feat in its first attempt. Mission's cost-effective approach and successful execution served as a model for future space missions, emphasizing the importance of innovation, efficiency, and frugality in space exploration. It strengthened international cooperation in space exploration and encouraged knowledge-sharing and scientific advancements. The **Mangalyaan mission** exemplifies India's capabilities in space technology and exploration. It demonstrates the nation's commitment to scientific research, technological innovation, and its contribution to global space exploration endeavors. 2) The **Apollo 11 mission** is one of the most iconic and historic moments in human space exploration. It was the first crewed mission to land humans on the Moon and thus, represented a significant milestone in human history, showcasing the extraordinary capability of humans to travel to another celestial body and return safely. It was launched by NASA, the United States' space agency, and took place from July 16 to 24, 1969. Neil Armstrong famously declared, "That's one small step for man, one giant leap for mankind," as he became the first person to set foot on the Moon. It continues to inspire and captivate people's imaginations, serving as a testament to human ingenuity, scientific progress, and the enduring spirit of exploration.	1) "The sky is not the limit; it's just the beginning." – **Unknown** 2) "Exploration is wired into our brains. If we can see the horizon, we want to know what's beyond." - **Buzz Aldrin** 3) "Space exploration is a force that unites humanity, transcending borders and inspiring us to push the boundaries of what's possible." - **Mae Jemison**

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20 Tribal rights and Forest conservation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Dongria Kondh and Niyamgiri Hills**: The story of the Dongria Kondh and their fight to protect the Niyamgiri Hills highlights the significance of **indigenous communities' land rights, cultural heritage, and environmental conservation**. The Dongria Kondh are an indigenous tribal community residing in the Niyamgiri Hills in the state of Odisha, India. The Dongria Kondh have a rich cultural heritage and maintain a close bond with their ancestral land, the Niyamgiri Hills. They have their unique language, customs, and traditions, which have been passed down through generations. The Niyamgiri Hills hold immense spiritual and cultural significance for the Dongria Kondh. They believe that the hills are the abode of their deity, Niyam Raja, who protects and provides for their community. The hills are revered as sacred and are central to their identity and way of life. a) However, the proposed mining operations **threatened the Dongria Kondh's way of life**, as it could have resulted in displacement, environmental degradation, and loss of their sacred lands. b) The case reached the **Supreme Court of India**, which ruled in favor of the Dongria Kondh, recognizing their rights to determine mining activities on their ancestral lands. Their struggle has become an emblematic case for indigenous rights and the need to balance development and environmental concerns. 2) **Amrita Devi and Khejri tree: Amrita Devi** was a member of the Bishnoi community, a religious and ecological sect that reveres nature and wildlife. The Bishnois are known for their strong beliefs in environmental conservation and protecting trees and animals. In 1730, the **Maharaja of Jodhpur ordered the cutting of Khejri trees** in the village of Khejarli in Rajasthan. The Khejri tree holds cultural and ecological importance in the arid regions of Rajasthan. Hence, Amrita Devi, along with other members of the Bishnoi community, bravely stood up against the tree felling. They **hugged the trees** and declared that they would rather sacrifice their lives than see the trees being cut down. The **sacrifice of Amrita Devi and the Bishnoi community** brought attention to the importance of environmental conservation and inspired a broader movement for tree protection and afforestation in India. 3) **Urban Forestry:** The **Delhi Ridge** stands as an exemplar of **urban forestry** in India, demonstrating the importance of preserving and enhancing green spaces within urban areas. It is a forested area located in the outskirts of New Delhi, the capital city of India. It stretches across a vast area of approximately 7,700 hectares, covering various parts of the city. It is	1) "Trees are the lungs of the city, providing oxygen, shade, and a connection to nature." – **Unknown** 2) "In the concrete jungle, urban forests are the oasis of tranquility and biodiversity." – **Unknown** 3) "Urban forests are nature's gift to cities, providing beauty, serenity, and a respite from the hustle and bustle." - **Unknown**

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considered a **crucial ecological asset** as it serves as a **natural green lung** for the city. It showcases the benefits of **integrating nature into cities, promoting ecological balance, enhancing the quality of life for residents, and conserving biodiversity**.	

Data:

1) Constitutional provisions:
   a) DPSP – Article 48A: State shall endeavour to protect and improve the environment and to safeguard the forests and wild life of the country.
   b) Fundamental Duty – Article 51A (g): Duty of every citizen of India to protect and improve the natural environment including the forests of our country.
2) Total forest cover is 21.7% of the geographical area of the country.
3) 'Green Wall' of India project: Ambitious plan to create a 1,400 kms long and 5kms wide green belt from Gujarat to the Delhi-Haryana border.
4) Best Practice: Odisha is the first State in the country to make budgetary provision for implementation of the Forests Rights Act – ₹8 crore for 168 FRA cells in 2021-22.

21 Blockchain Technology

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Blockchain in humanitarian needs**: Blockchain technology can revolutionize the delivery of humanitarian assistance by increasing efficiency, transparency, and empowerment. In 2017, **the World Food Programme (WFP) initiated a pilot project called Building Blocks**, which utilized blockchain technology to deliver cash assistance to **Syrian refugees living in Jordanian camps**. The objective was to enhance the efficiency, transparency, and security of aid distribution while empowering refugees to make choices and access their entitlements more easily. The use of blockchain technology gave refugees greater autonomy and choice in how they used their assistance. It also facilitated quicker and more secure transfers of funds, ensuring timely access to assistance for the refugees. The transparent nature of blockchain enabled stakeholders to track aid flows and verify transactions, increasing trust and accountability in the aid delivery process. 2) **Voting Systems:** Blockchain has the potential to enhance the security and transparency of voting systems. **West Virginia**, for instance, implemented a blockchain-based mobile voting platform in its 2018 primary elections. The system allowed military personnel stationed overseas to vote securely and	1) "Blockchain is the next layer of the internet's evolution, a new public infrastructure for the digital age." - **Alex Tapscott**, Co-author of "Blockchain Revolution" 2) "Blockchain is not just a technology, but a new architecture of trust." - **Primavera De Filippi**, Researcher and Author 3) "Blockchain is the future. It is going to change every aspect of our lives." - **William Mougayar**, Author of "The Business Blockchain"

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remotely, ensuring the integrity of the electoral process.

3) **Supply Chain Management**: Blockchain has been applied to enhance supply chain transparency and traceability. **For example**, **Walmart partnered with IBM** to create a blockchain-based system that tracks the movement of food products from farms to store shelves. This enables quick identification of the source of contamination during food recalls and helps ensure the authenticity and quality of products.

4) **Intellectual Property:** Blockchain can help protect intellectual property rights by creating an immutable record of ownership and usage. **For example,** the company called **Verisart** uses blockchain technology to create digital certificates of authenticity for artworks. This enables artists to prove the authenticity and provenance of their work, reducing the risk of counterfeiting.

5) **The DAO Hack**: In 2016, a decentralized autonomous organization (DAO) called "The DAO" was launched on the Ethereum blockchain. The DAO was essentially a smart contract-based investment fund that allowed participants to vote on funding proposals. However, a vulnerability in the DAO's code was exploited, resulting in the theft of approximately one-third of the funds held by the organization, amounting to around $50 million worth of Ether at the time.
This case study highlighted the potential security risks and vulnerabilities associated with smart contracts and blockchain applications.

22 Electoral Reforms

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Voter Education and Awareness:** The Election Commission conducts voter awareness campaigns, voter education programs, and outreach activities to promote electoral participation and inform voters about their rights and responsibilities. SVEEP (Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation) is an initiative by the Election Commission of India (ECI) aimed at promoting voter awareness and increasing voter participation in the electoral process. These campaigns have contributed to increased voter registration, improved voter turnout, and greater public engagement in the electoral process in India. 2) **Introduction of Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT):** The	1) "Democracy cannot succeed unless those who express their choice are prepared to choose wisely. The real safeguard of democracy, therefore, is education." - **Franklin D. Roosevelt** 2) "The vote is not only the most precious right of every citizen but also the most

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implementation of VVPAT alongside EVMs provides a physical paper trail for each vote cast, allowing voters to verify their vote and enhancing transparency and trust in the electoral process. The introduction of VVPAT in India has enhanced transparency, boosted voter confidence, and provided an additional layer of verification to the electoral process thus, can act as a deterrent to electoral malpractices and manipulation. 3) **Introduction of NOTA (None of the Above) Option:** The Supreme Court of India directed the Election Commission to include the NOTA option on electronic voting machines in 2013. This reform gives voters the right to reject all candidates contesting in an election, promoting the principle of negative voting.	powerful nonviolent tool to create a more perfect union." - **John Lewis** 3) "The vote is not just a tool, it's a weapon against oppression and injustice." - **Daisaku Ikeda** 4) "Voting is not just a right—it's a duty and responsibility." - **Kamala Harris**

23 Disaster Management

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Cyclone Phailin, India (2013):** Cyclone Phailin hit the eastern coast of India in 2013, affecting millions of people. The disaster management response involved the largest evacuation in the country's history, relocating over one million people to safer areas. The successful execution of the evacuation plan, timely dissemination of warnings, and effective coordination between government agencies and local communities significantly reduced the loss of life. 2) **Tohoku Earthquake and Tsunami, Japan (2011):** The Great East Japan Earthquake and Tsunami in 2011 resulted in widespread devastation, loss of life, and the Fukushima nuclear disaster. Japan's disaster management response was highly organized and efficient, with effective early warning systems, evacuation plans, and emergency response measures. The country's robust disaster management infrastructure, including public awareness campaigns, earthquake-resistant building codes, and strong coordination between government agencies and local communities, contributed to saving lives and facilitating recovery. 3) **India's response to the COVID-19 pandemic** has been multifaceted and involved various strategies to mitigate the spread of the virus and manage the impact on public health and the economy. In March 2020, India implemented one of the world's largest and strictest lockdowns, imposing movement restrictions and suspending non-essential activities to contain the spread of the virus. India focused on expanding	1) "Failing to prepare is preparing to fail." - **John Wooden** 2) "Disasters happen, lives can be saved." – **Unknown** 3) "The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining." - **John F. Kennedy** 4) "Preparation through education is less costly than learning through tragedy." - **Max Mayfield** 5) "The best way to mitigate the effects of disasters is to invest in preparedness and prevention." - **Ban Ki-moon**

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testing capacity to identify and isolate infected individuals. Efforts were made to strengthen healthcare infrastructure, including the establishment of dedicated COVID-19 hospitals, quarantine centers, and isolation facilities. India initiated an extensive vaccination campaign, aiming to vaccinate its vast population against COVID-19.

India actively engaged in international collaborations by supplying vaccines to other countries through the "Vaccine Maitri" initiative and participated in forums like the World Health Organization (WHO) and the Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Innovations (CEPI) to share knowledge and resources.

Data:

1) 54% of the geographical area of India is vulnerable to earthquakes.
2) The Indian subcontinent with a long coastline of 8041 kilometres is exposed to nearly 10% of the world's tropical cyclones.
3) 15 % of the Indian landmass prone to landslides.
4) Drought risk in India: 68% of country prone to drought.
5) According to UNEP, the number of wildfires is likely to increase by up to 14% by 2030. It is projected to spike by 33% by 2050. It would rise by 52% by 2100.
6) According to the Forest Survey of India (FSI), 36% of India's forest cover are estimated to be prone to forest fire.

24 Cultural Conservation

Anecdotes/Poems	Quotes
1) **Revitalization of Varanasi Ghats, Uttar Pradesh:** The ghats (steps leading to riverbanks) along the Ganges River in Varanasi are an integral part of the city's cultural and religious fabric. Over time, pollution, neglect, and encroachments threatened the heritage value of the ghats. The Varanasi Riverfront Development Project, initiated by the government, aimed to rejuvenate and restore the ghats. This project involved cleaning the river, strengthening the ghats, renovating structures, and improving amenities for pilgrims and visitors. 2) **Preservation of Khajuraho Temples, Madhya Pradesh:** The Khajuraho Group of Monuments, known for its exquisite temple sculptures, faced degradation and damage due to weathering and human activities. The Archaeological Survey of India undertook conservation efforts to stabilize and restore the temples. The project involved cleaning, consolidation of stone surfaces, and reassembly of fallen elements. Today, the Khajuraho Temples are recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site.	1) "A society without culture is like a tree without roots." - **Amit Kalantri** 2) "Cultural heritage is the mirror of a nation's soul, the compass of its creativity, and the anchor of its identity." - **Francesco Bandarin** 3) "Cultural diversity is our strength, and its preservation enriches us all." - **Kofi Annan** 4) "The conservation of cultural heritage is an act of love for our past and a gift to future generations." - **Unknown**

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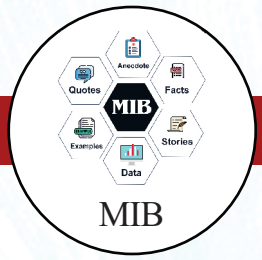
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Open Test-01 with Evaluation		
Date/Day	9 AM to 12 PM	2 PM to 5 Pm
11-Aug Fri	_____	Paper-I (Essay)
12-Aug Sat	Paper-II (GS-I)	Paper-III (GS-II)
13-Aug Sun	Paper-IV (GS-III)	Paper-V (GS-IV)

Open Test-02 *CSE Mains PYQ with F2F Feedback		
Date/Day	9 AM to 12 PM	2 PM to 5 Pm
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26-Aug Sat	Paper-II (GS-I)	Paper-III (GS-II)
27-Aug Sun	Paper-IV (GS-III)	Paper-V (GS-IV)

Open Test-02 *No Evaluation		
Date/Day	9 AM to 12 PM	2 PM to 5 Pm
1-Sep Fri	_____	Paper-I (Essay)
2-Sep Sat	Paper-II (GS-I)	Paper-III (GS-II)
3-Sep Sun	Paper-IV (GS-III)	Paper-V (GS-IV)

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